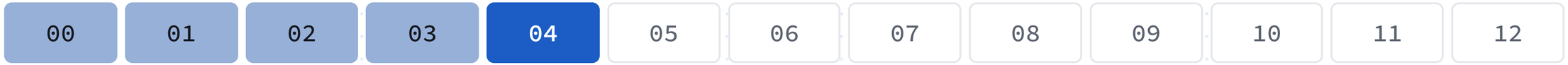
MODULE 04 · AMBITIOUS ENTREPRENEURSHIP

# Validating Problems

## What evidence would change your mind?

COURSE PATH



COURSE MATERIAL · SCAN NOW

# All slides live on GitHub

The newest version, free, no account needed

github.com/BaNburger/
AmbitiousEntrepreneurship

1. **Open the link**
   github.com/BaNburger/AmbitiousEntrepreneurship
2. **Go to modules**
   then 04-validating-problems
3. **Click the lecture PDF**
   M04_Lecture_Validating-Problems.pdf, download top right

Public course repository of Ambitious Entrepreneurship. The QR code opens github.com/BaNburger/AmbitiousEntrepreneurship.

WHERE WE ARE · THE COURSE

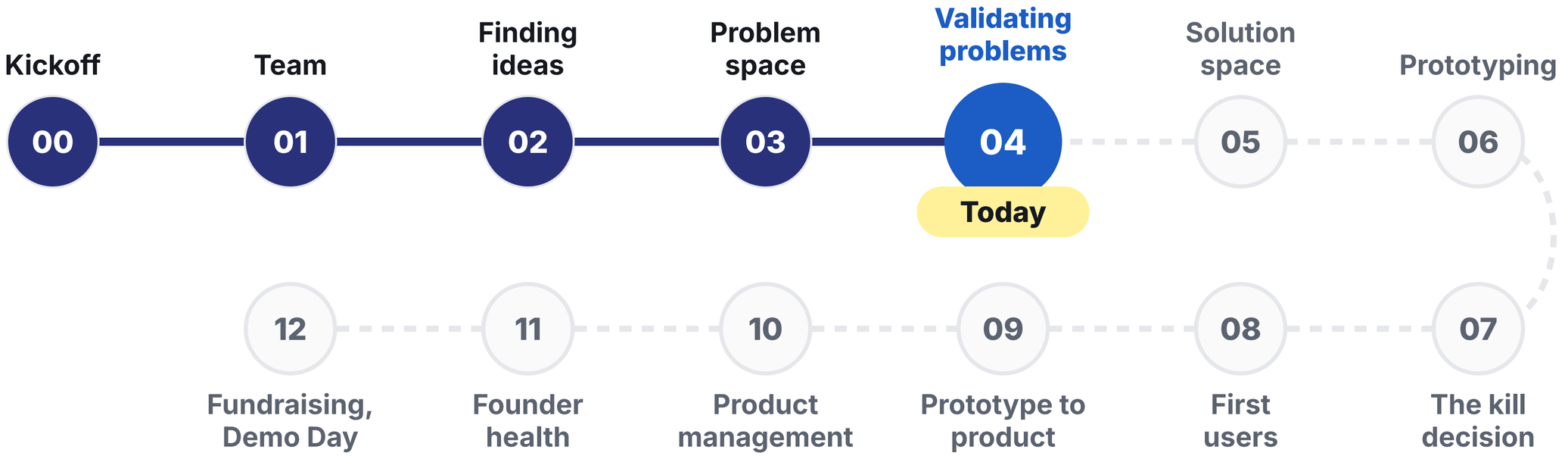
# From what people say to what they do

Thirteen sessions from first idea to first revenue. What teams have by now:

**One idea, picked on evidence**
Finding ideas (M02)

**A hair-on-fire segment**
Problem space (M03)

**Named people for a next step**
Problem space (M03)



CHECK-IN · SHOW OF HANDS

# How many people agreed to a next step?

Hands up for your band. One click on the band per hand

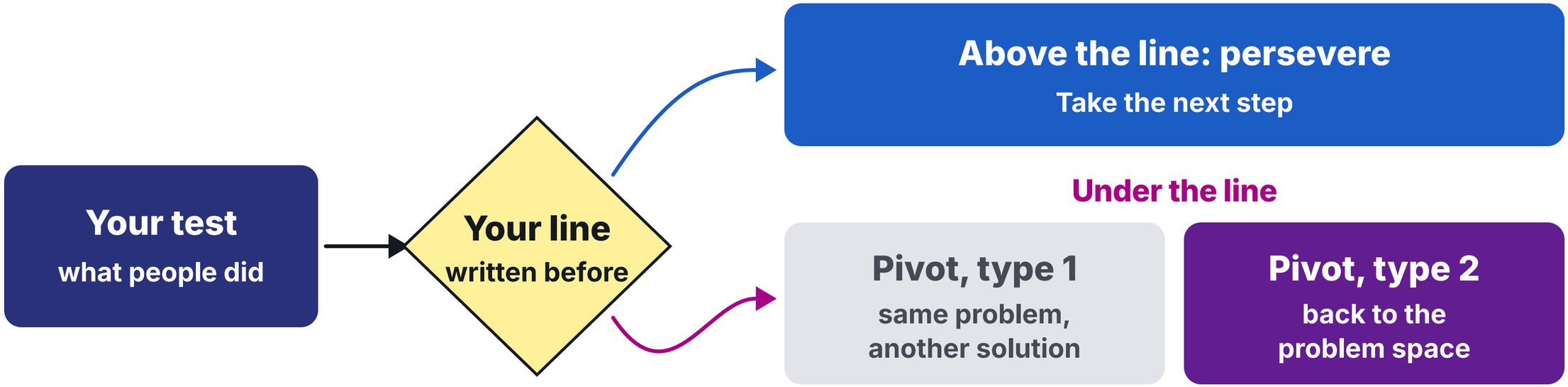
| 0 | 1 | 2–4 | 5+ |
|---|---|---|---|
| not yet | started | floor reached | full bar |
| | under the floor of 2 | | 5 per student |

2:00

PIVOT OR PERSEVERE

# Under your line? That is a decision, not a failure

Before there is a solution, a pivot goes back to the problem




**Both are progress. The only miss: no line, so no decision**

**FRAMEWORK** Pivot or persevere after Ries, E. (2011), The Lean Startup. Pivot types as in the course Glossary.

ACCOUNTABILITY

# Three questions, every session

**1**

**User interactions?**

What did you learn?

**2**

**New revenue?**

Why did they pay?

**3**

**Shipped?**

Why does it matter?

🦄 **Report target vs. actual in small groups**

CHAPTER 1 OF 9

# Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship

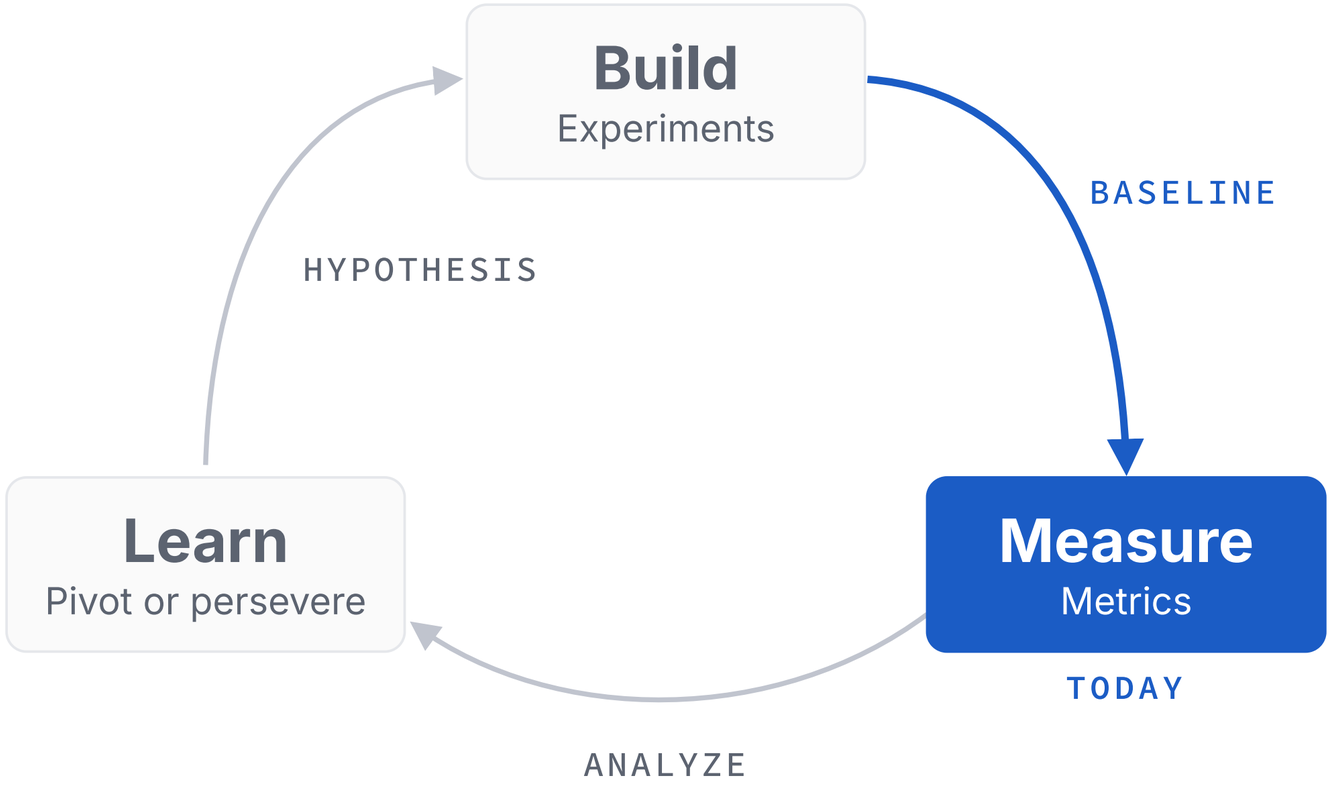
You heard who hurts, and from today you count who acts.


01 **Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship**
02 Your presentations
03 **Rank it: what your evidence proves**
04 **Draw it: the line before the data**
05 **Launch it: a page that tests your problem**
06 **Count it: visitors from your segment**
07 Wrap-up and check-out
08 Workshop: launch a page that tests your problem
09 Case discussion

PREVIOUSLY · KICKOFF (M00)

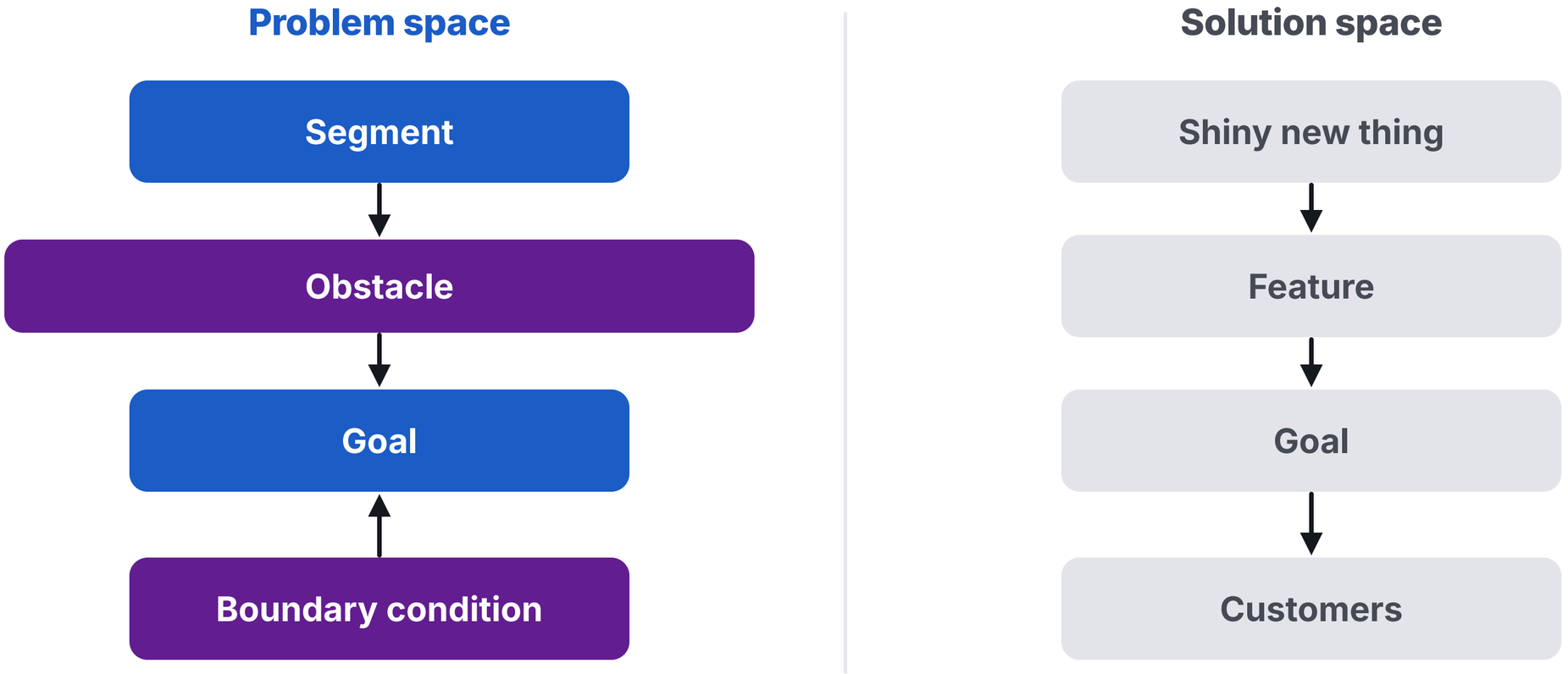
# Your idea is a hypothesis

Today you measure what people do



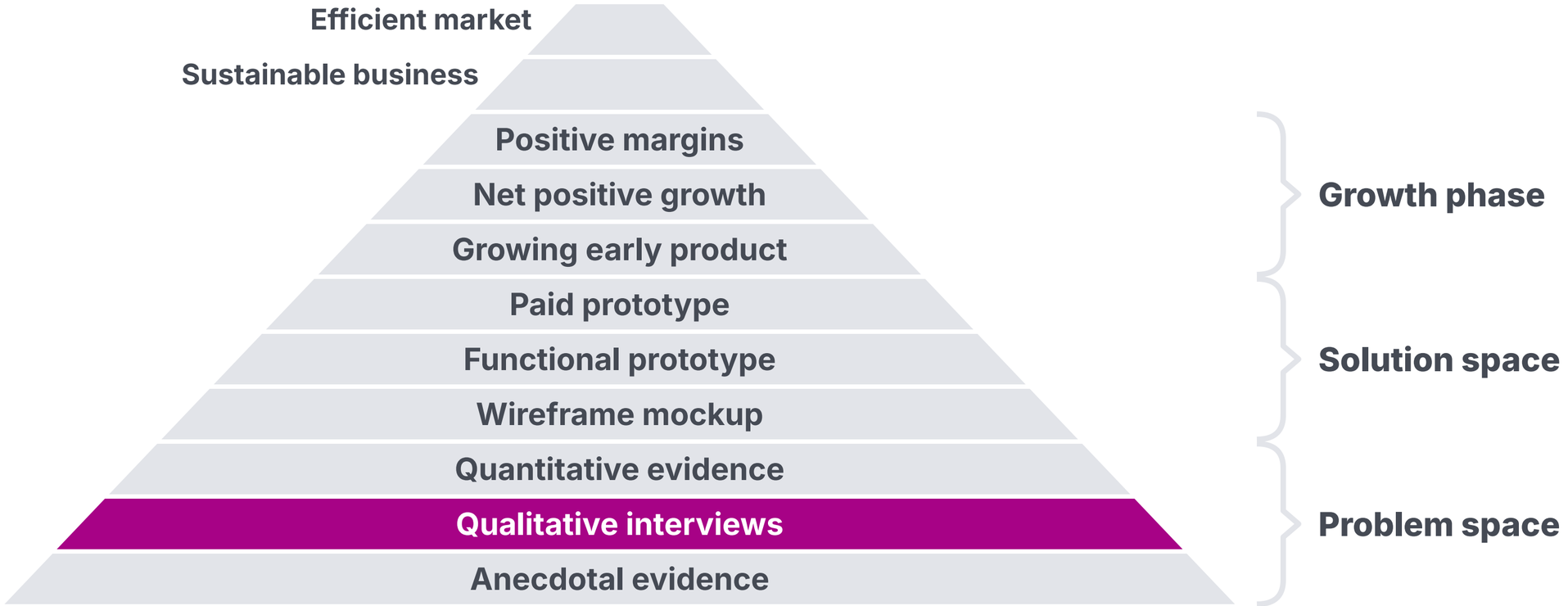
PREVIOUSLY · PROBLEM SPACE (M03)

# You know who hurts. Now count who acts



PREVIOUSLY · PROBLEM SPACE (M03)

# You stood on the second step



TODAY'S QUESTION · HANDS

# What evidence would change your mind?

1:00

CHAPTER 2 OF 9

# Your presentations

Three minutes per team to show what your records say since last time.


01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 **Your presentations**

03 **Rank it: what your evidence proves**

04 **Draw it: the line before the data**

05 **Launch it: a page that tests your problem**

06 **Count it: visitors from your segment**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 Workshop: launch a page that tests your problem

09 Case discussion

YOUR PRESENTATIONS · MAKE IT CREDIBLE

# Show us where you're at in 3 minutes or less!

3:00

## Facts

**Statistics or research**

What does your segment spend?

Where is it from?

## 12 Numbers

**Your Interview Log**

Conversations held

Next steps agreed

Spend in € or hours

## Quotes

**Interviews**

The three that decided it

## Images

**Screenshots or users**

The workaround, if they showed it

**Verdict: segment, job, stay or switch**

**Hypothesis: three people likely to pay first**

**What did you do?**

**What did you learn?**

**How can we help?**

INPUT 1 OF 4 · CHAPTER 3 OF 9

# Rank it: what your evidence proves

What you know is only as strong as the step it stands on.


01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 ~~Your presentations~~

03 **Rank it: what your evidence proves**

04 **Draw it: the line before the data**

05 **Launch it: a page that tests your problem**

06 **Count it: visitors from your segment**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 Workshop: launch a page that tests your problem

09 Case discussion

INPUT 1 OF 4 · RANK IT · THREE QUESTIONS

# What is your evidence worth?

**1**

**Which evidence is strongest?**

**2**

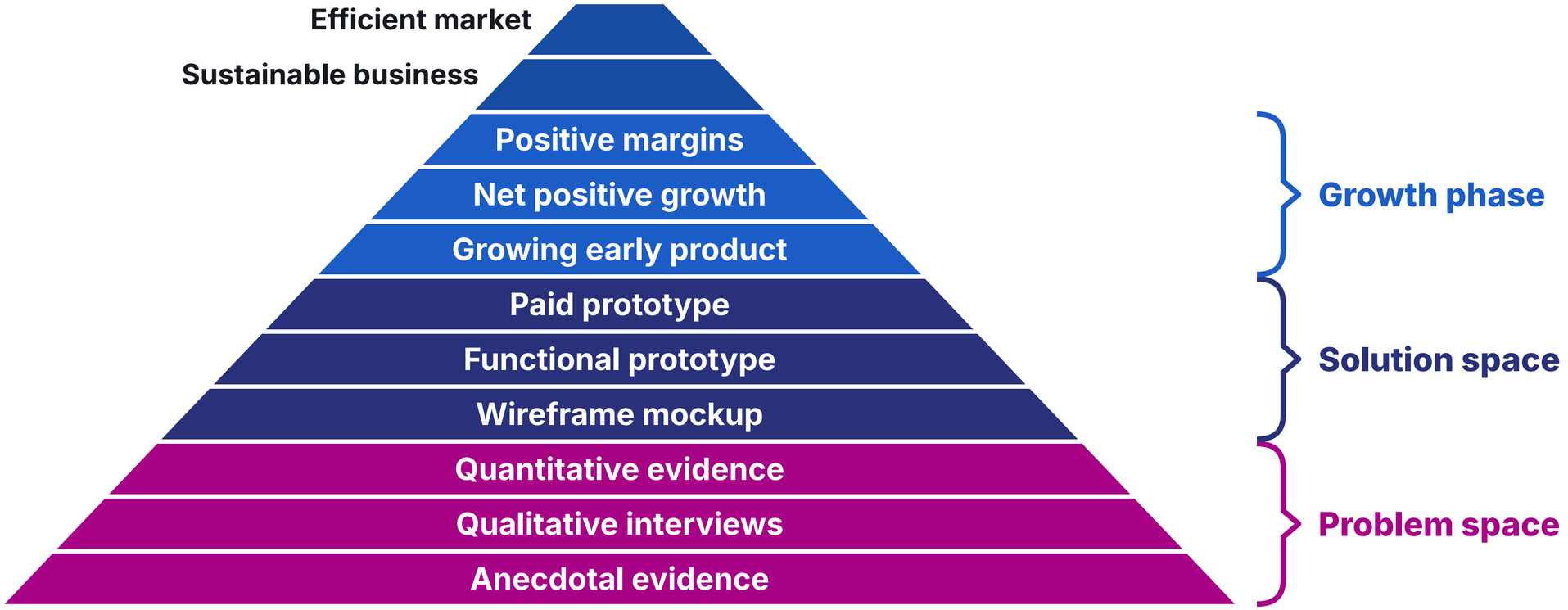
**When does a survey count?**

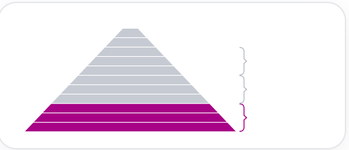
**3**

**What validates a problem?**

CORNERSTONE · HIERARCHY OF EVIDENCE

# Climb from what they say to what they pay





THE RUNNING EXAMPLE · THE ARM THAT HURTS

# Anecdotes diagnose. Interviews theorize. Numbers verify

**Anecdote**

N under 5 · subjective



"When I do this, my arm hurts."

## Diagnose

**Interviews**

N under 20 · unstructured



"Doing this is ok, but that hurts."

## Theorize

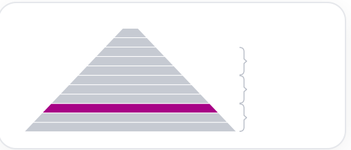
**Numbers**

N over 20 · structured



"Sore arm in 90% of runs against a pole."

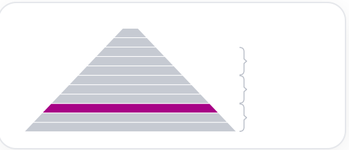
## Verify



SURVEYS · WHEN THEY COUNT

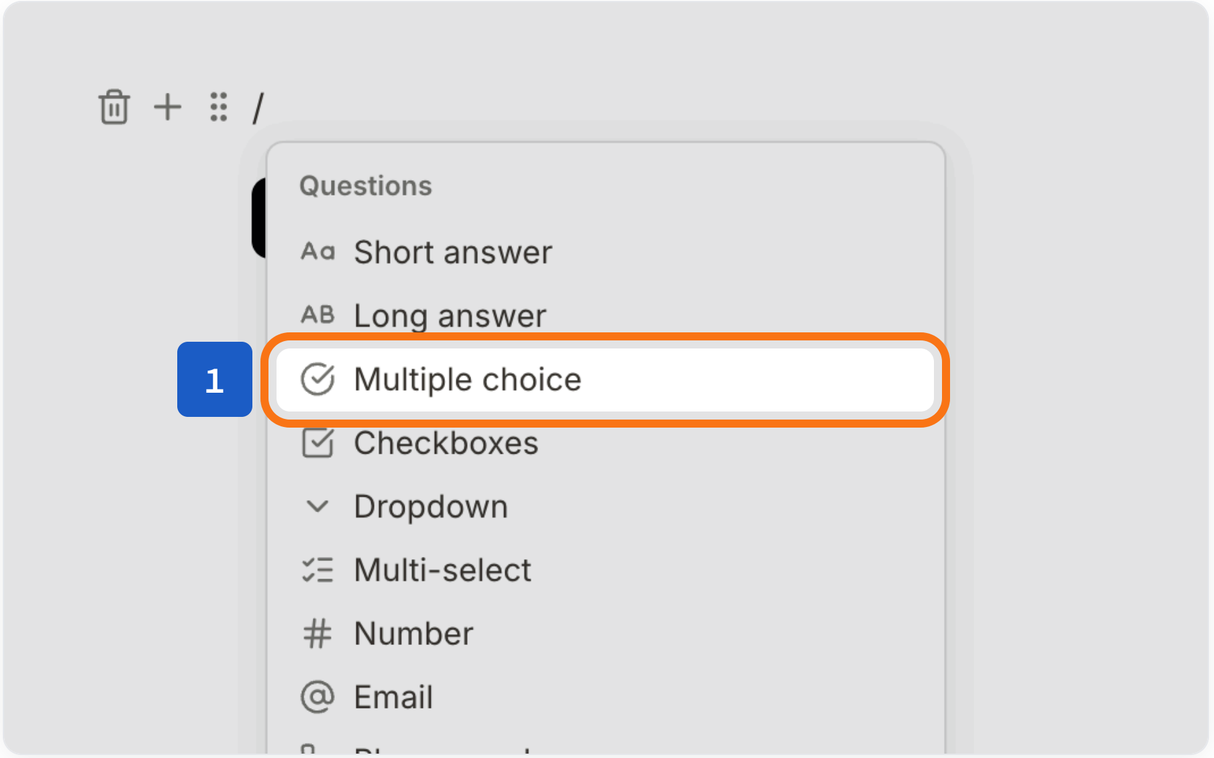
# A survey counts only when it asks about the past

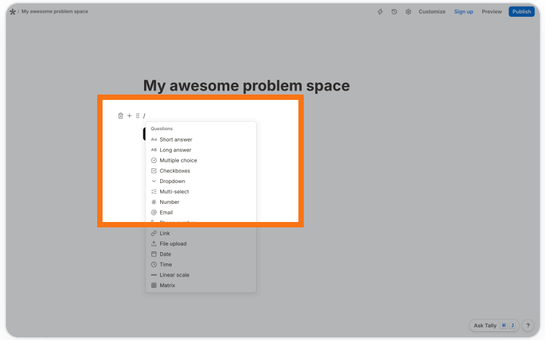
1. **"How often did it hurt last month?"**
   ~~"Tell me about instances when it hurts."~~
2. **Never mention your solution**
   ~~"This is what we build, do you like it?"~~
3. **Role and context, to count your segment**
4. **Short, in their words**



HOW-TO · SURVEY · STEP 1 OF 4

# Build the form in ten minutes




1 **Build the form**

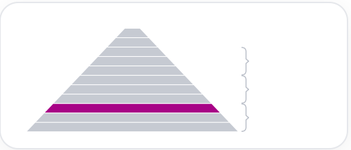
2 Ask about the past

3 Send it to people who acted

4 Let AI count, then check

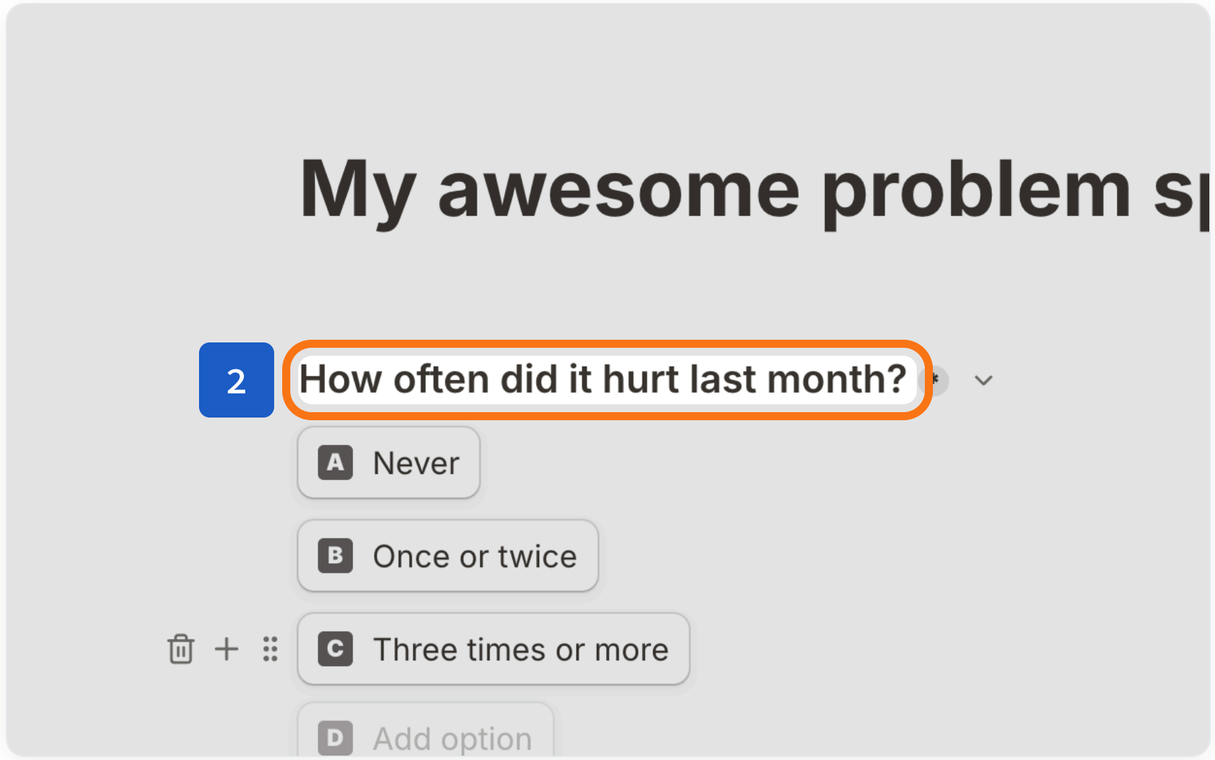
Closed questions only.

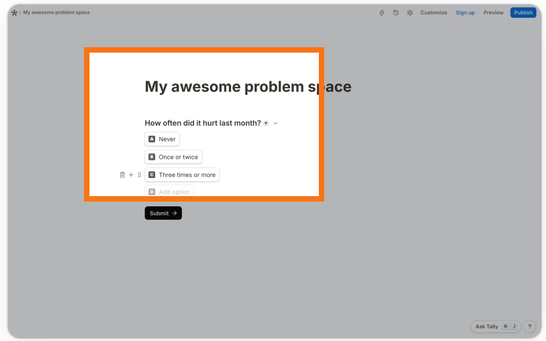
Screenshots of tally.so as of 26 October 2026, captured with scripts/shots.py. Example form typed for this deck. Any form tool works.



HOW-TO · SURVEY · STEP 2 OF 4

# Ask about the past

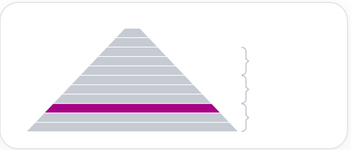



1. Build the form
2. **Ask about the past**
3. Send it to people who acted
4. Let AI count, then check

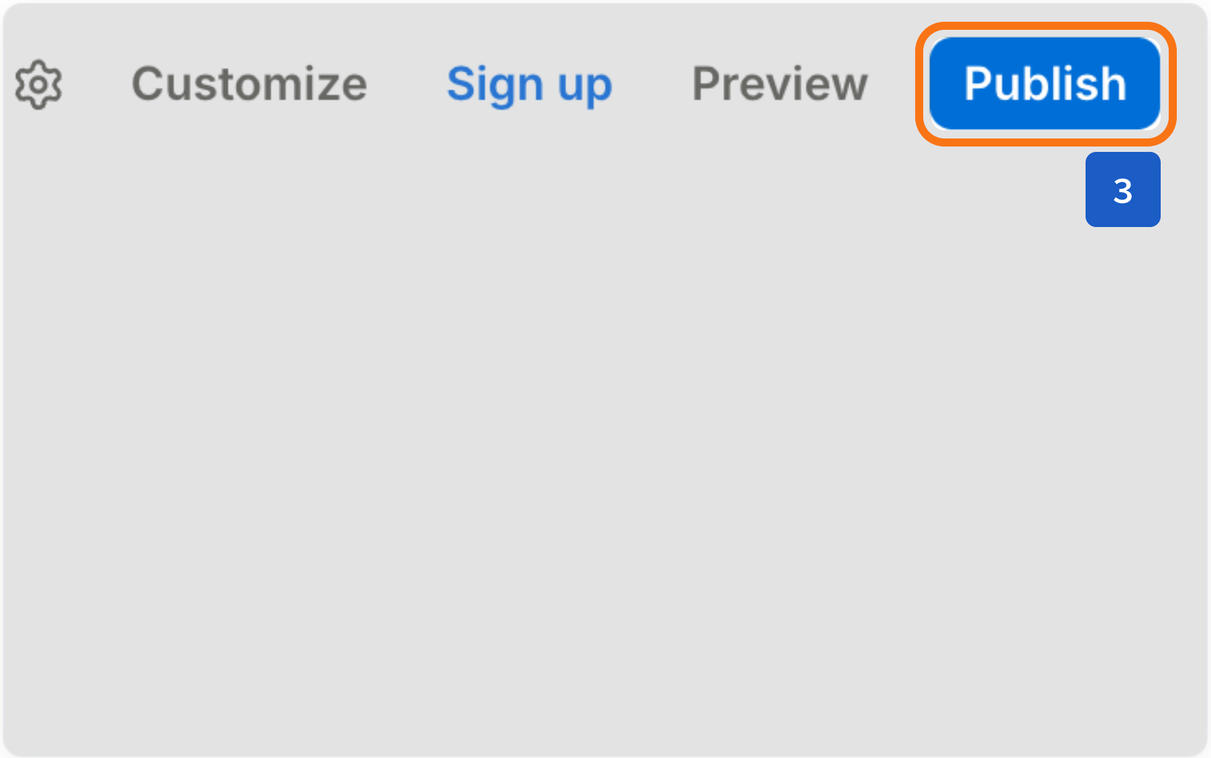
One question about last month, three closed answers

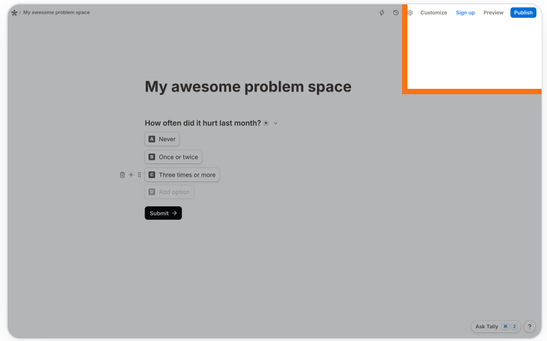
Screenshots of tally.so as of 26 October 2026, captured with scripts/shots.py. Example form typed for this deck. Any form tool works.



HOW-TO · SURVEY · STEP 3 OF 4

# Send it to people who acted

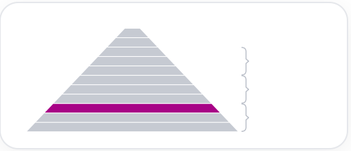



1. Build the form
2. Ask about the past
3. **Send it to people who acted**
4. Let AI count, then check

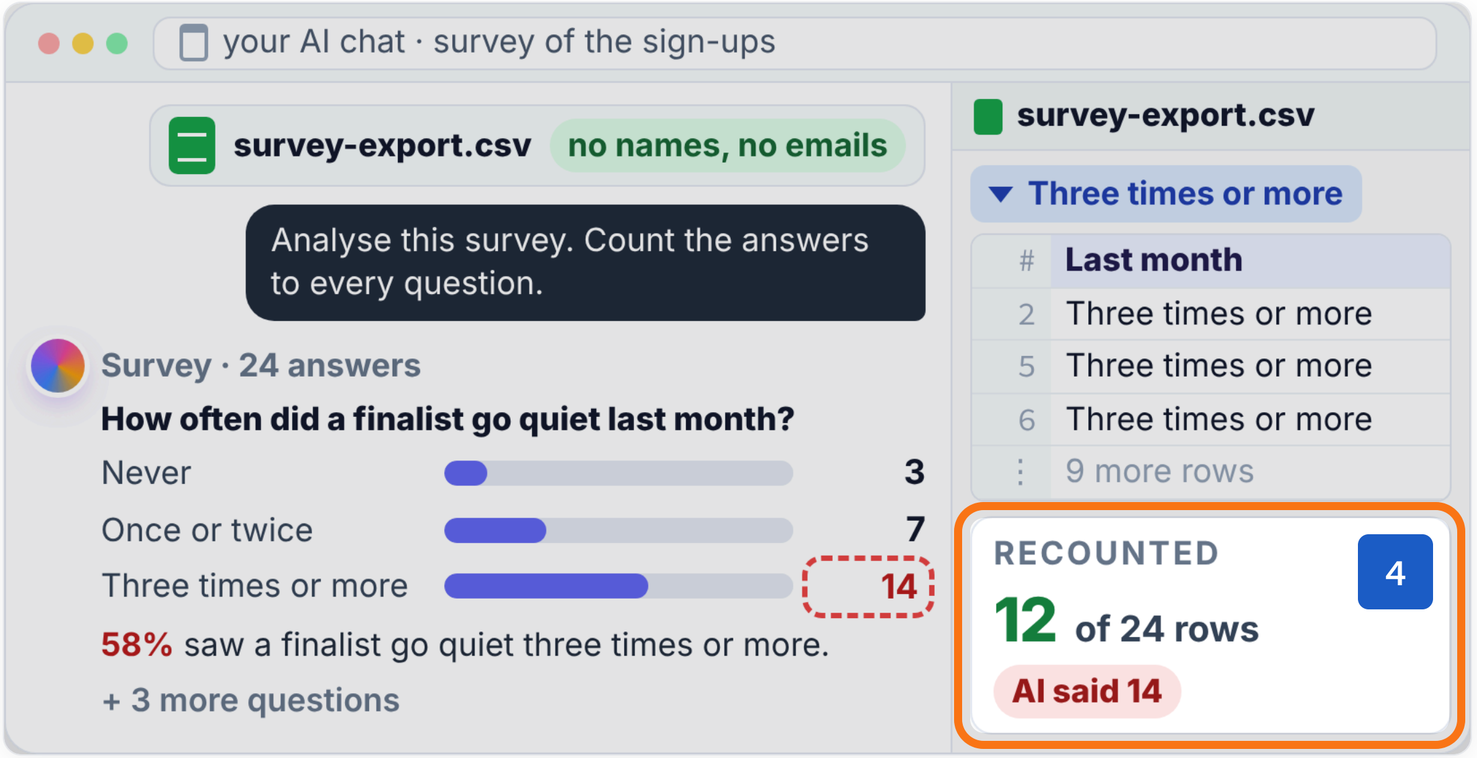
Only to people who already acted, your sign-ups

Screenshots of tally.so as of 26 October 2026, captured with scripts/shots.py. Example form typed for this deck. Any form tool works.



HOW-TO · SURVEY · STEP 4 OF 4

# Let AI count. Check every number



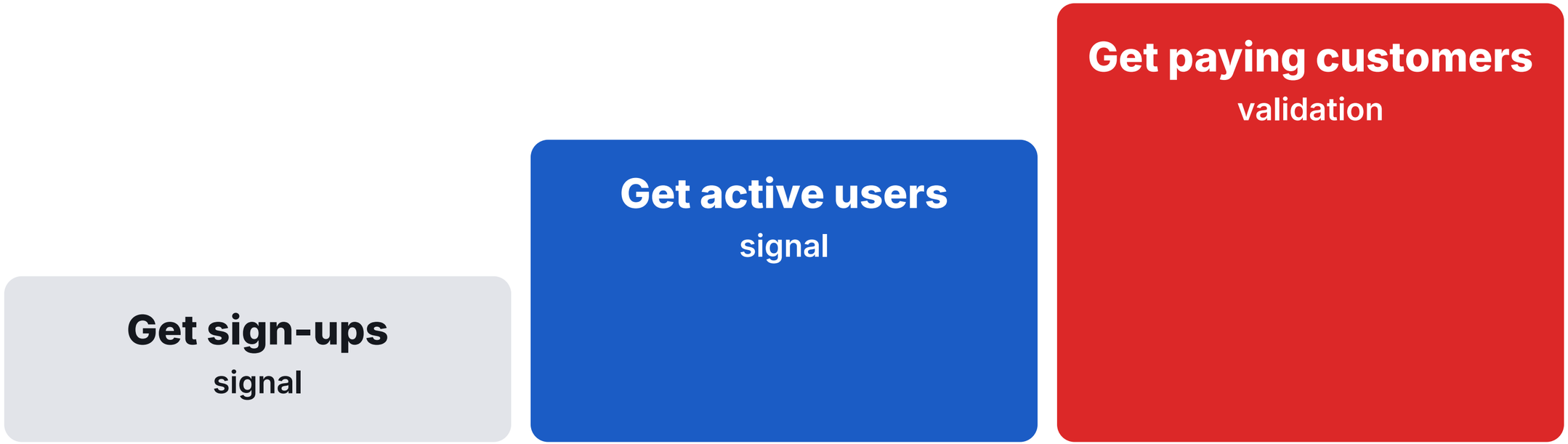

1. Build the form
2. Ask about the past
3. Send it to people who acted
4. **Let AI count, then check**

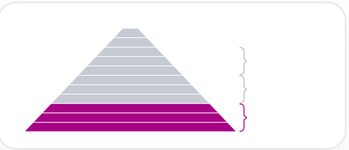
Export without names and emails.

**ILLUSTRATIVE** Screen prototyped for this course, answers and numbers made up.

MANTRA

# Real validation comes through the credit card





NOW YOU · AS A TEAM · 3 MINUTES

# Put your evidence on the pyramid

**Anecdote** What did one person say?

**Interviews** What did many say?

**Number** What did 20+ do?

**Limit** What does it not prove?

3:00

OUTPUT

**Your top step, honestly**

INPUT 1 OF 4 · RANK IT · THE ANSWERS

# Rank it: saying, doing, paying

**1**

Which evidence is strongest?

**What people do and pay beats what they say. Numbers verify**

**2**

When does a survey count?

**Only when it asks about the past and never mentions your solution**

**3**

What validates a problem?

**Sign-ups and users are signal. Validation comes through the credit card**

INPUT 2 OF 4 · CHAPTER 4 OF 9

# Draw it: the line before the data

Write down what would change your mind before the first visitor arrives.


01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 ~~Your presentations~~

03 ~~Rank it: what your evidence proves~~

04 **Draw it: the line before the data**

05 **Launch it: a page that tests your problem**

06 **Count it: visitors from your segment**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 Workshop: launch a page that tests your problem

09 Case discussion

INPUT 2 OF 4 · DRAW IT · THREE QUESTIONS

# What would change your mind?

**1**

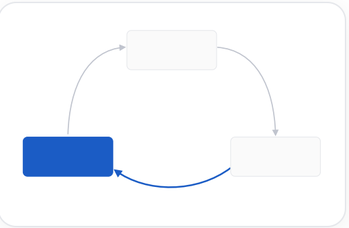
**Why write the line before the data?**

**2**

**What goes on a test card?**

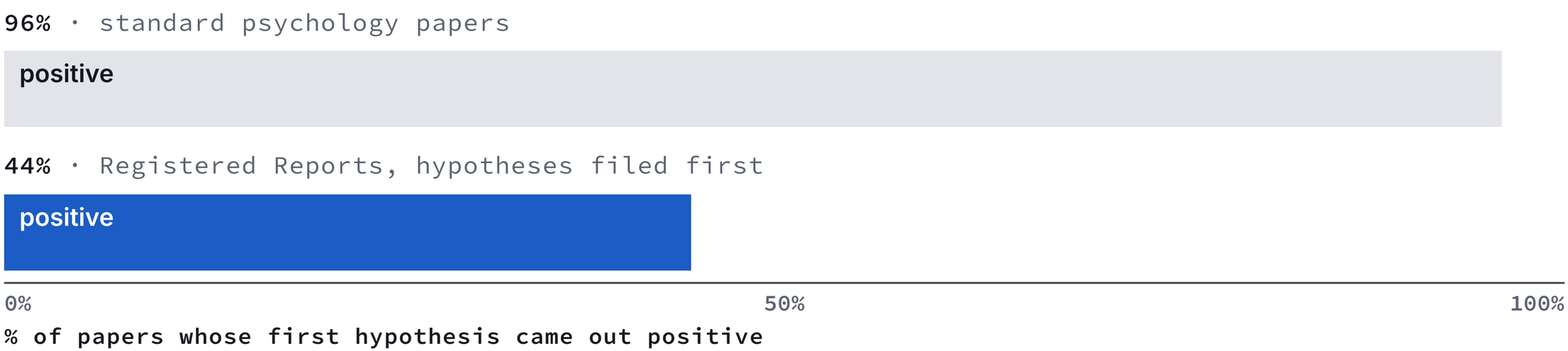
**3**

**What if you miss the line?**



WHY IT MATTERS

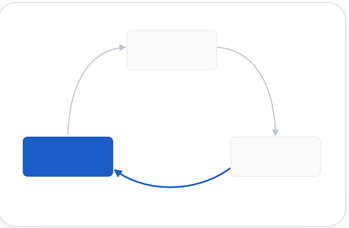
# Decide after the data, and everything says yes




**57% → 8%**
heart trials with a benefit, before and after 2000

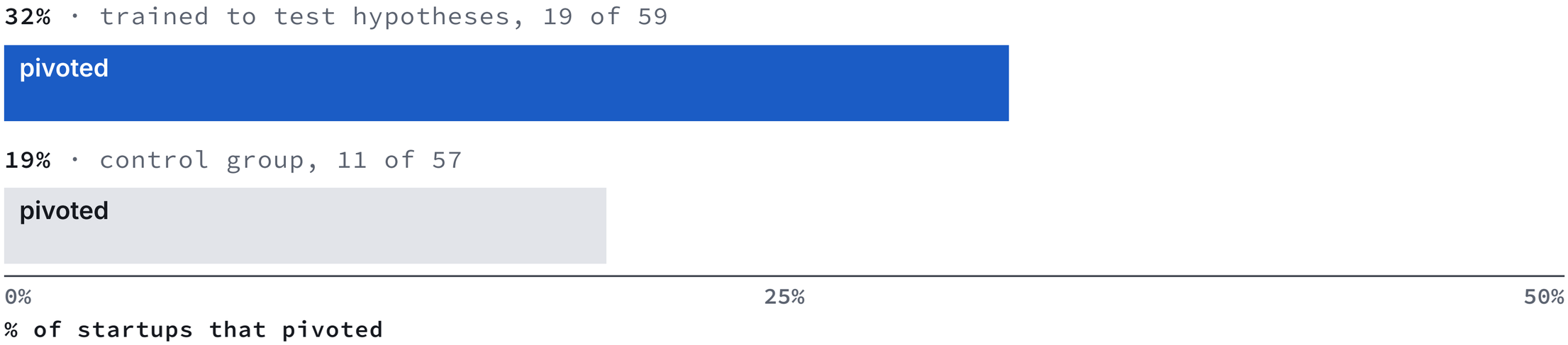
**87%**
of 67 top-journal trials needed a correction for their outcomes

**RESEARCH** Scheel, Schijen & Lakens (2021), 152 standard vs 71 Registered Reports, bars to scale. Kaplan & Irvin (2015), 55 trials. Goldacre et al. (2019).



WHY IT MATTERS · FOUNDERS

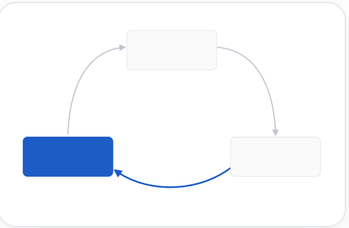
# Founders taught to test pivot more




**116**
Italian startups, randomized

**759**
firms in 2024: more ideas stopped

**RESEARCH** Camuffo, Cordova, Gambardella & Spina (2020), *Management Science*. Camuffo et al. (2024), *Strategic Management Journal*. Bars to scale, 0 to 50%.

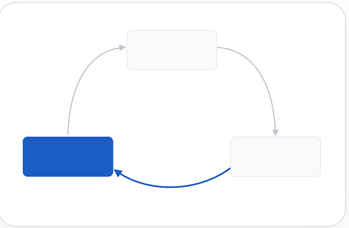


TEST CARD · BEFORE ANYONE VISITS

# Write the test before the page exists

| | |
|---|---|
| **We believe** | [segment] will [action] when we promise [outcome] |
| **To verify, we** | publish the page, bring [N] visitors from [sources] |
| **And measure** | the share of segment visitors who take the action |
| **We are right if** | [X]% or more by [date], logged today |
| **Then** | pass: [next step] · fail: switch segment or problem |

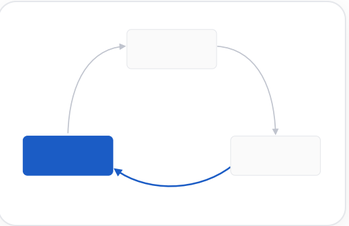
**FRAMEWORK** Test card after Bland, D. J., & Osterwalder, A. (2019). *Testing Business Ideas*. Wiley. Course material, redrawn with a "Then" row.



EXAMPLE · A TEST CARD

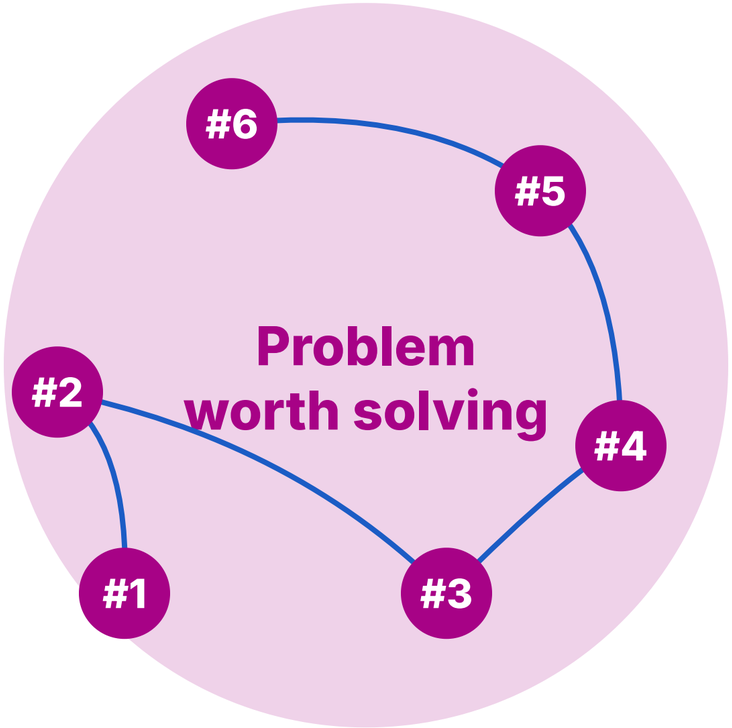
# Even an interview test gets a number

| | |
|---|---|
| **We believe** | new founders struggle to structure their processes |
| **To verify, we** | hold 15 interviews with early-stage founders |
| **And measure** | their difficulty, rated from 1 to 10 |
| **We are right if** | 10 out of 15 rate it 7 or higher |
| **Time** | 2 weeks |



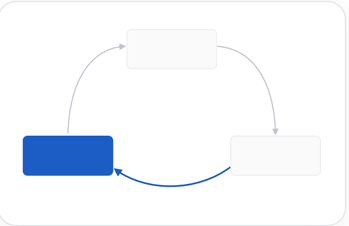
WHEN YOU MISS THE LINE

# Missed the line? Move inside the problem space




You are passionate about it
Your audience is passionate about it
You can make a good living from it

Each hop is the next segment or problem



NOW YOU · AS A TEAM · 3 MINUTES

# Write your test card

| | |
|---|---|
| **We believe** | [segment] will [action] |
| **We measure** | share of segment visitors |
| **We pass at** | [X]% by [date] |
| **Then** | pass, and fail |

3:00

OUTPUT

**One card, dated today**

INPUT 2 OF 4 · DRAW IT · THE ANSWERS

# Draw it: the line comes first

**1**

Why write the line before the data?

**Decide after the data, and everything says yes. Founders who test pivot more**

**2**

What goes on a test card?

**Segment, action, promise, visitors and sources, and the share that passes by a date**

**3**

What if you miss the line?

**Move inside the problem space: the next segment or problem**

INPUT 3 OF 4 · CHAPTER 5 OF 9

# Launch it: a page that tests your problem

A page in their words with one button is your first quantitative test.


01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 ~~Your presentations~~

03 ~~Rank it: what your evidence proves~~

04 ~~Draw it: the line before the data~~

05 **Launch it: a page that tests your problem**

06 **Count it: visitors from your segment**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 Workshop: launch a page that tests your problem

09 Case discussion

INPUT 3 OF 4 · LAUNCH IT · THREE QUESTIONS

# How does a page test a problem?

**1**

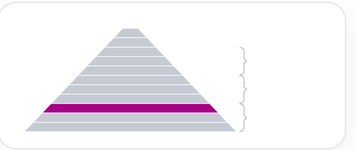
**Why a page before a product?**

**2**

**What goes on the page?**

**3**

**How fast can you build it?**

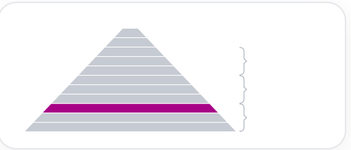


STORY · ZAPPOS, 1999

# He sold the shoes before he owned them

1. **No shop has the boots he wants**
2. **He photographs a shop's shoes**
3. **He puts the photos online**
4. **Someone orders. He buys the pair at full price**

**DATA** Swinmurn, N., as told to D. Eng (2012, 5 September). *Fortune*. Prather, M. (2000, 1 December). Sole proprietor. *Entrepreneur*.



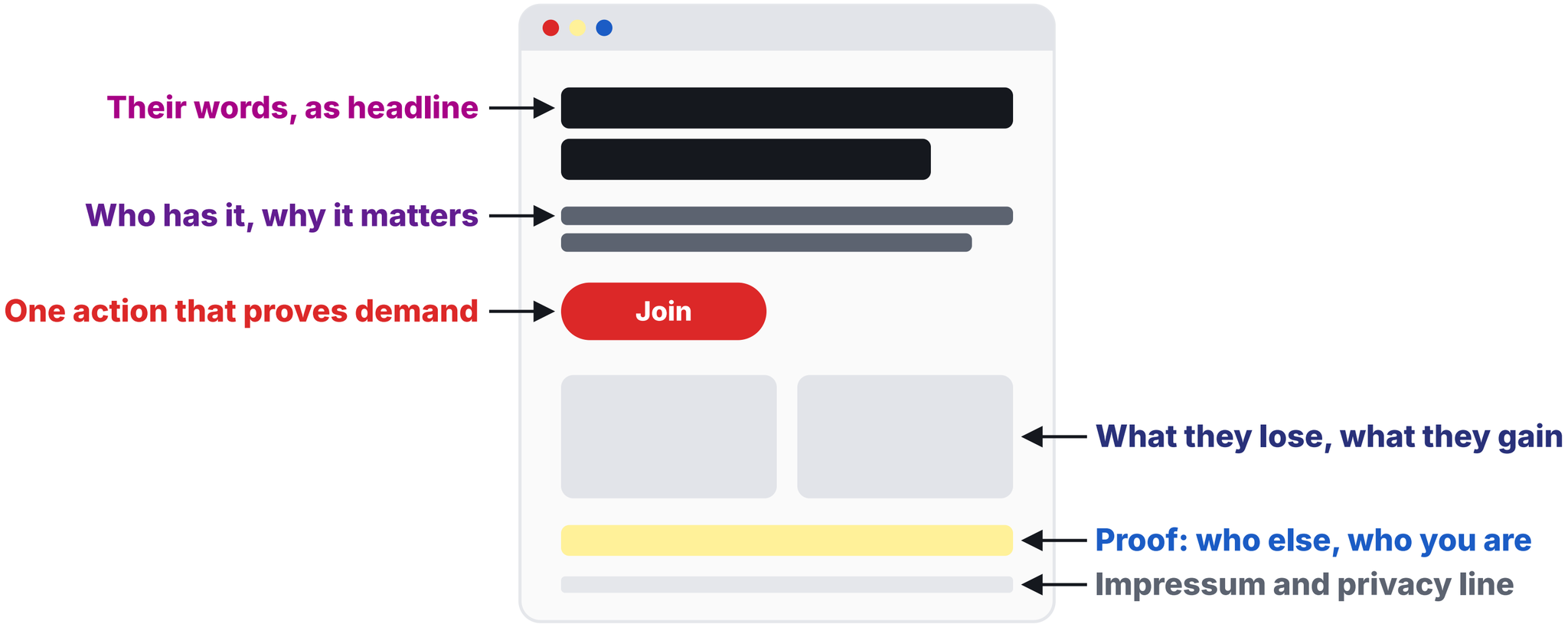
# Launch right away. A page is the smallest launch there is.

Only a launch shows whether you meet a need.

YC After Ralston, G. (2017, September 25). YC's essential startup advice. Y Combinator blog. Launching right away is the first piece of his advice.

ANATOMY · PROBLEM-SPACE PAGE

# Their problem, their words, one button



A REAL PAGE · READ IT TOP DOWN

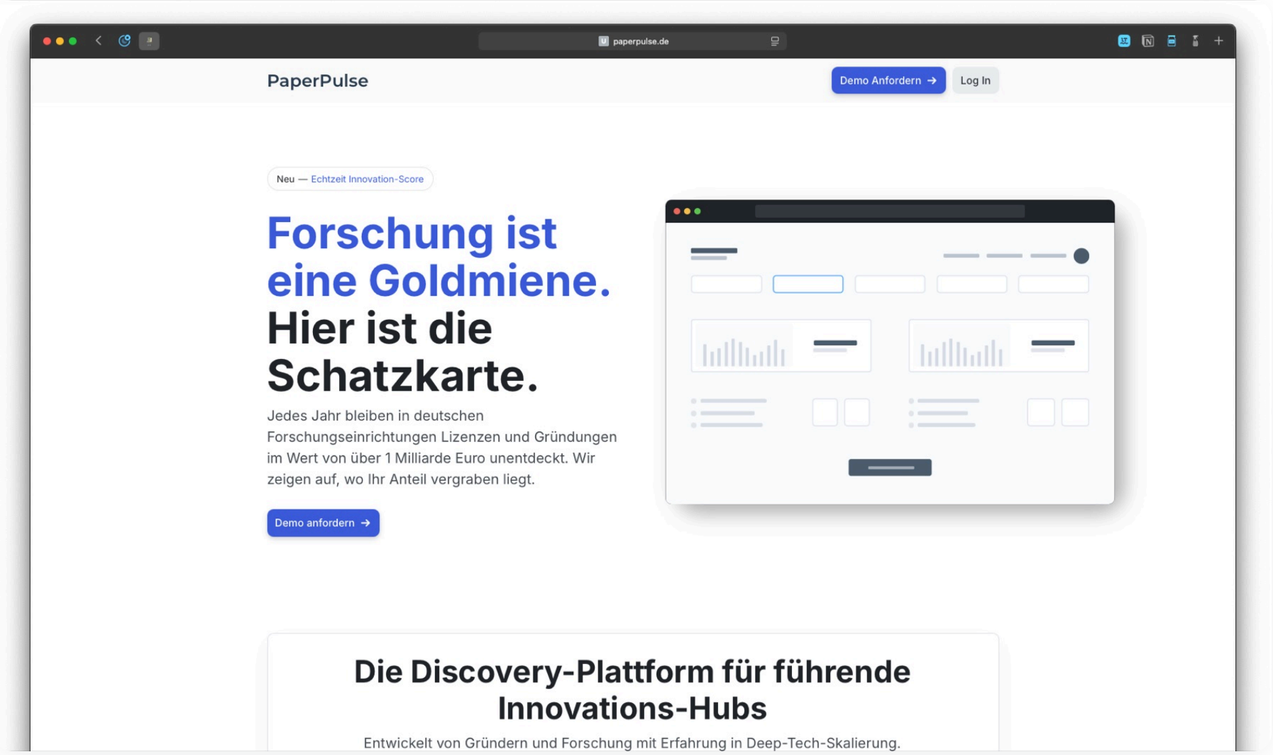
# Problem first. The product comes later

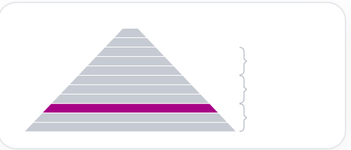
HEADLINE

"Research is a gold mine. Here is the treasure map."

ONE ACTION

**Request a demo**





LANDING PAGE CONTENT · TIP 1 OF 4

# Lead with the outcome they want

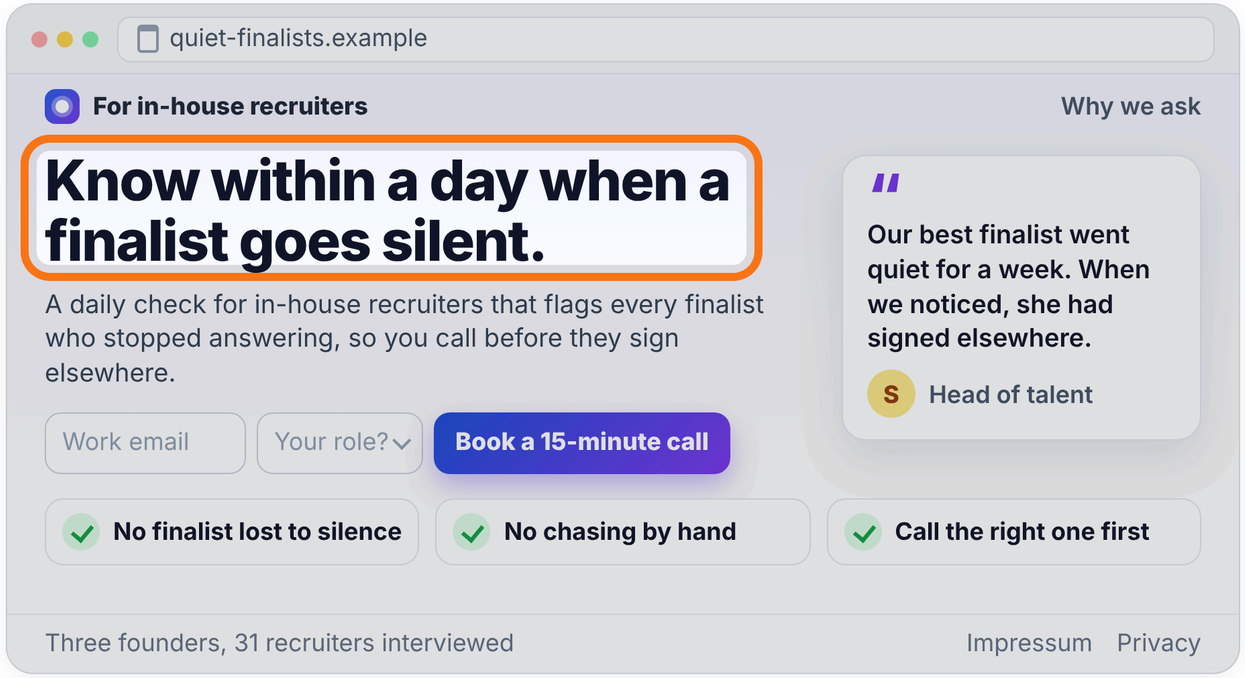
FROM

AI-powered recruiting platform

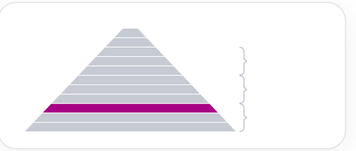
↓

TO

**Know within a day when a finalist goes silent**




**ILLUSTRATIVE** Page prototyped for this course, the made-up recruiting team of the workshop.



LANDING PAGE CONTENT · TIP 2 OF 4

# One line says what, for whom, which change

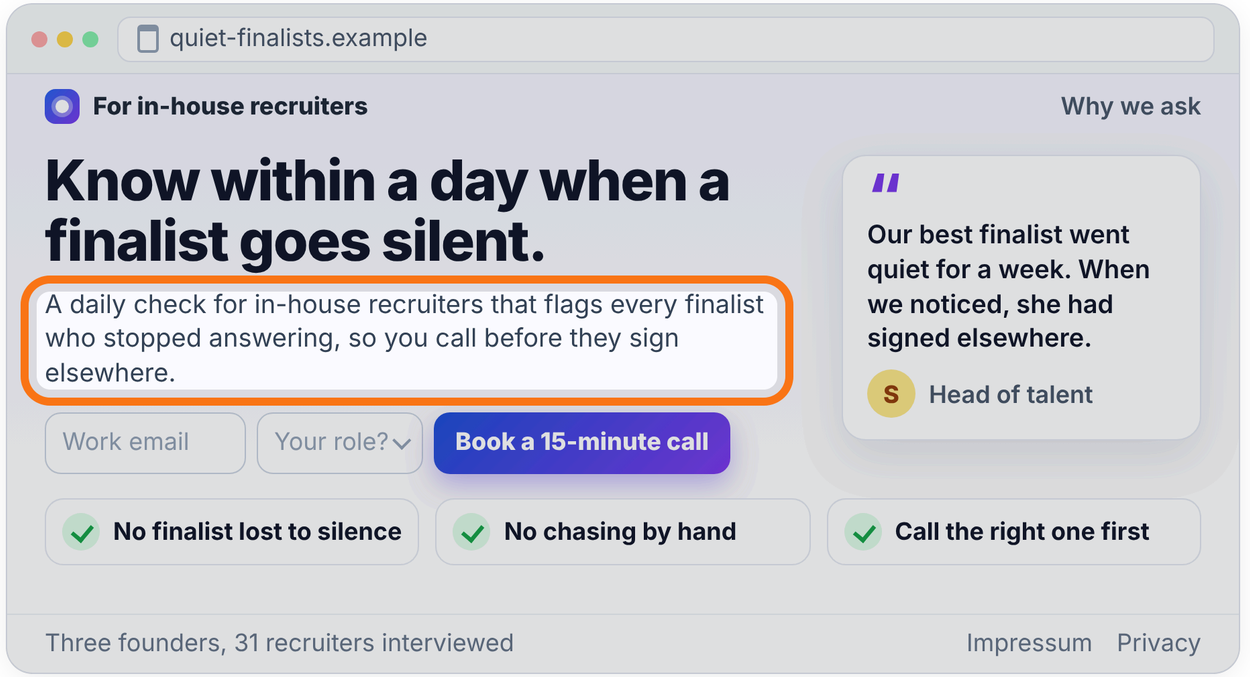
FROM

It's a recruiting tool

↓

TO

**A daily check for in-house recruiters that flags every finalist who stopped answering**




**ILLUSTRATIVE** Page prototyped for this course, the made-up recruiting team of the workshop.

LANDING PAGE CONTENT · TIP 3 OF 4

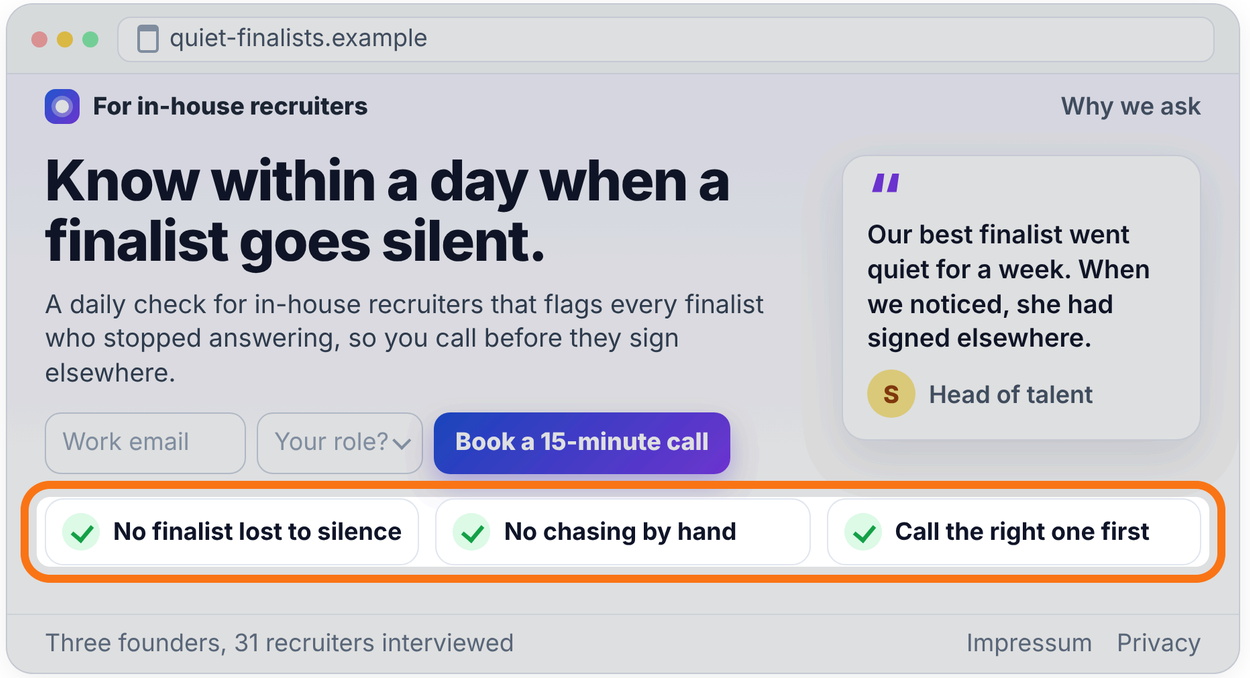
# Benefits, not features

FROM

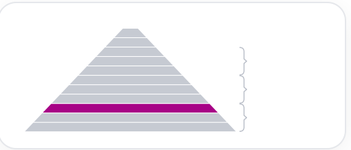
Features of your product

TO

**No finalist lost to silence. No chasing by hand.**




**ILLUSTRATIVE** Page prototyped for this course, the made-up recruiting team of the workshop.



LANDING PAGE CONTENT · TIP 4 OF 4

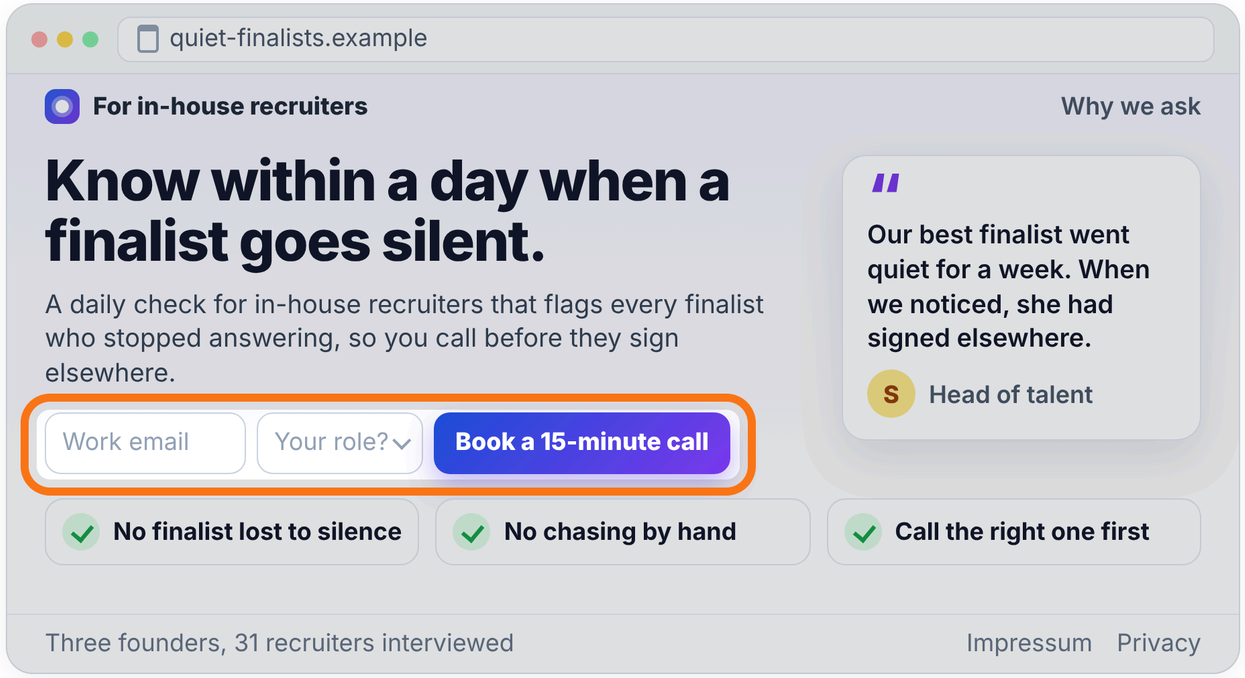
# Ask for the action that proves demand

FROM

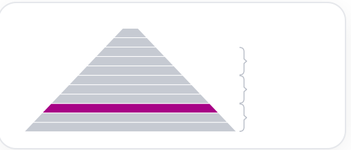
Learn more

TO

**Apply now · Book a call · Buy**




**ILLUSTRATIVE** Page prototyped for this course, the made-up recruiting team of the workshop.

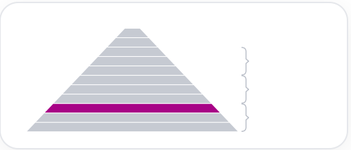


VOTE · HANDS

# Which button proves the most demand?

1. **Follow us**
2. **Join the waitlist**
3. **Book a 15-minute call**
4. **Pre-order**

1:00

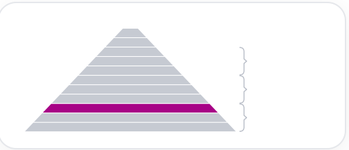


AI COPYWRITING

# Don't write from scratch. Start from their words

```
Act as a senior copywriter. Based on these interview notes [PASTE NOTES], write 5 variations of a Landing Page Hero Section (Headline + Subheadline + CTA) that addresses the core pain point directly.
```

A starting point, not the final copy.



NOW YOU · ALONE · 3 MINUTES

# Your headline, from one quote

**Quote** — What did they say, word for word?

**Problem** — In their words

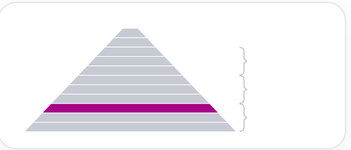
**Outcome** — What changes for them?

**Button** — One action

3:00

OUTPUT

**One hero section**



TOOLING TO TEST A PROBLEM SPACE

# Any builder works. Ship today

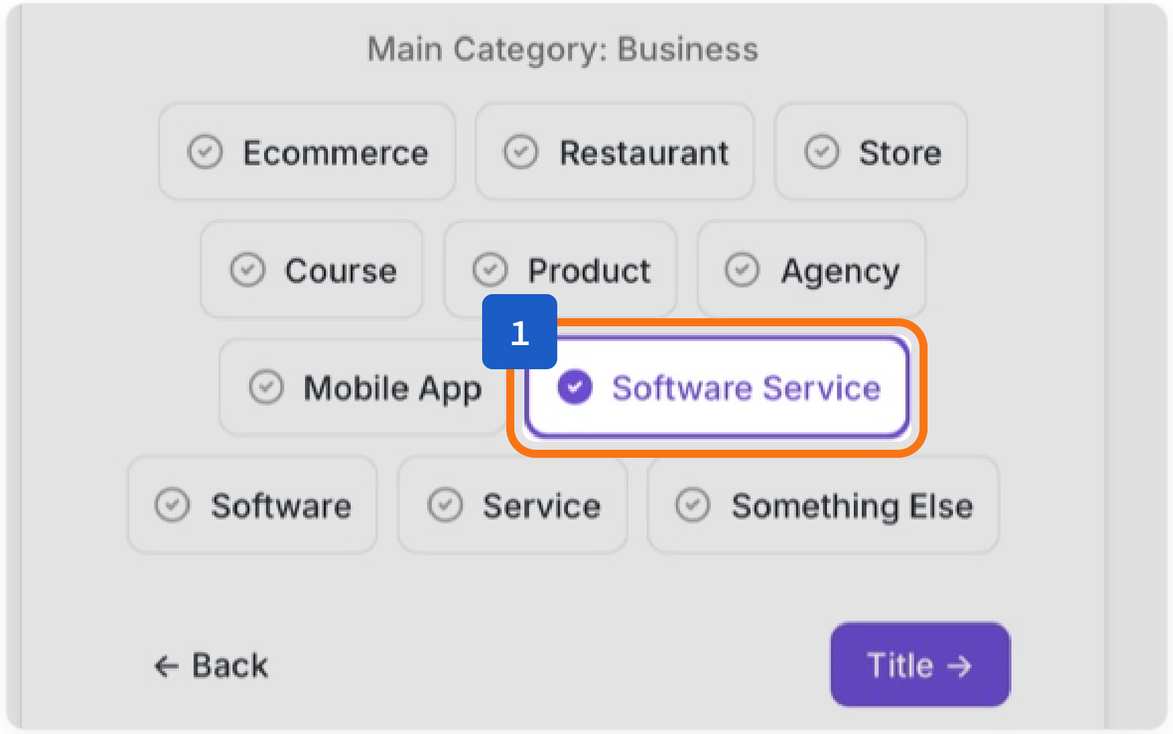
**Fast and simple** → **Flexible**

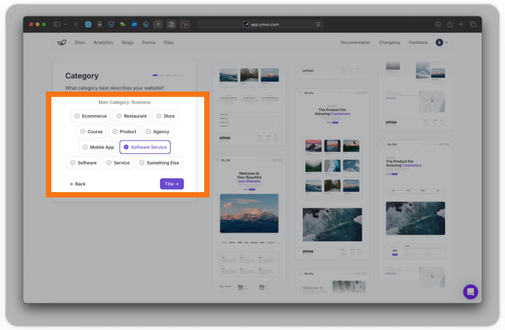
| Notion | Framer | Webflow | Lovable |
|---|---|---|---|
| A doc as a page | Free plan on a Framer domain | Free starter, more design | Vibe-coded, free daily credits |

Vendor pricing pages, as of October 2026. Logos are trademarks of their owners.

HOW-TO · BUILD A PAGE · STEP 1 OF 4

# Pick a template. Skip the design debate



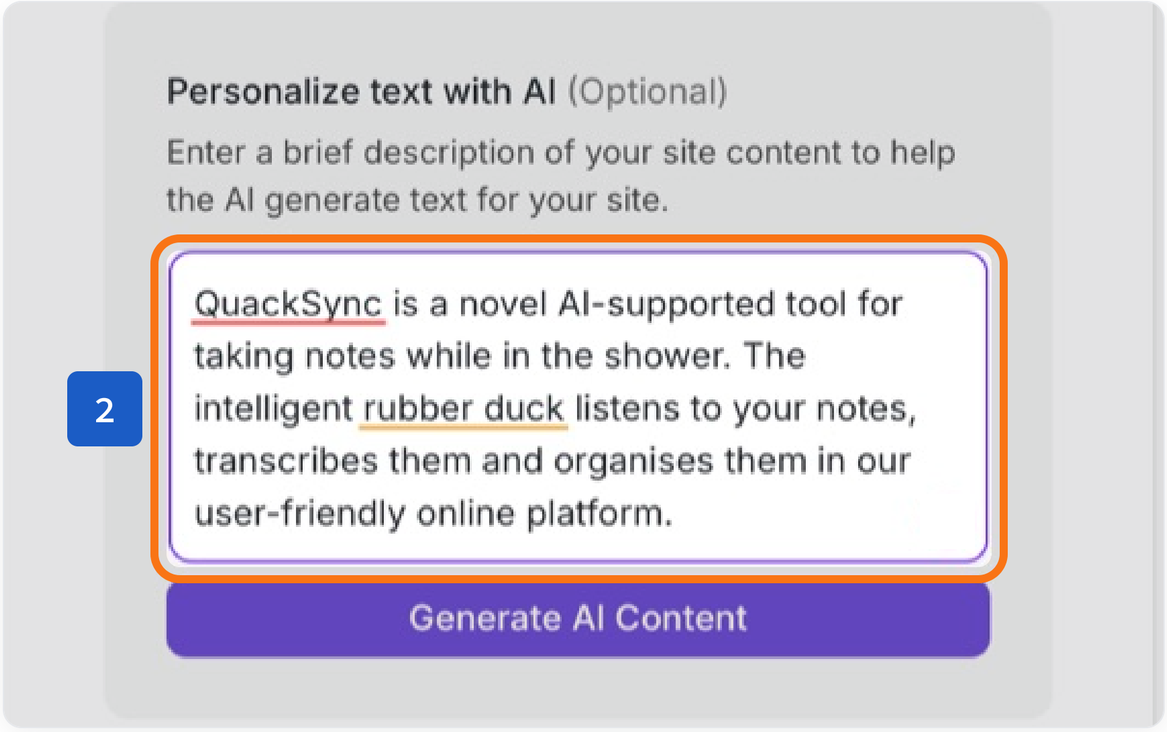



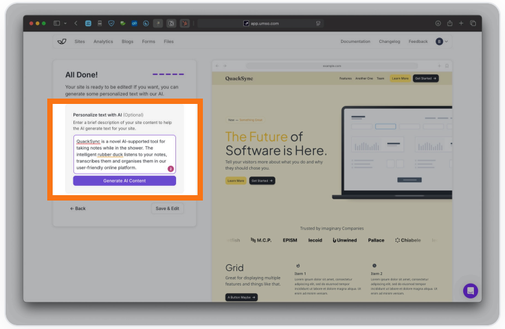
1. **Pick a template**
2. Describe the problem, let AI draft
3. Rewrite in their words
4. Publish on a free subdomain

Business, then your category.

HOW-TO · BUILD A PAGE · STEP 2 OF 4

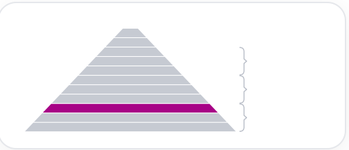
# Describe the problem. Let AI draft




1. Pick a template
2. **Describe the problem, let AI draft**
3. Rewrite in their words
4. Publish on a free subdomain

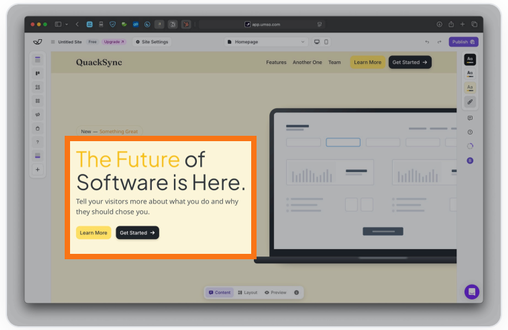
AI drafts. You decide.



HOW-TO · BUILD A PAGE · STEP 3 OF 4

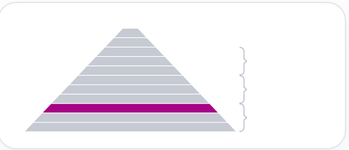
# Rewrite the hero in their words



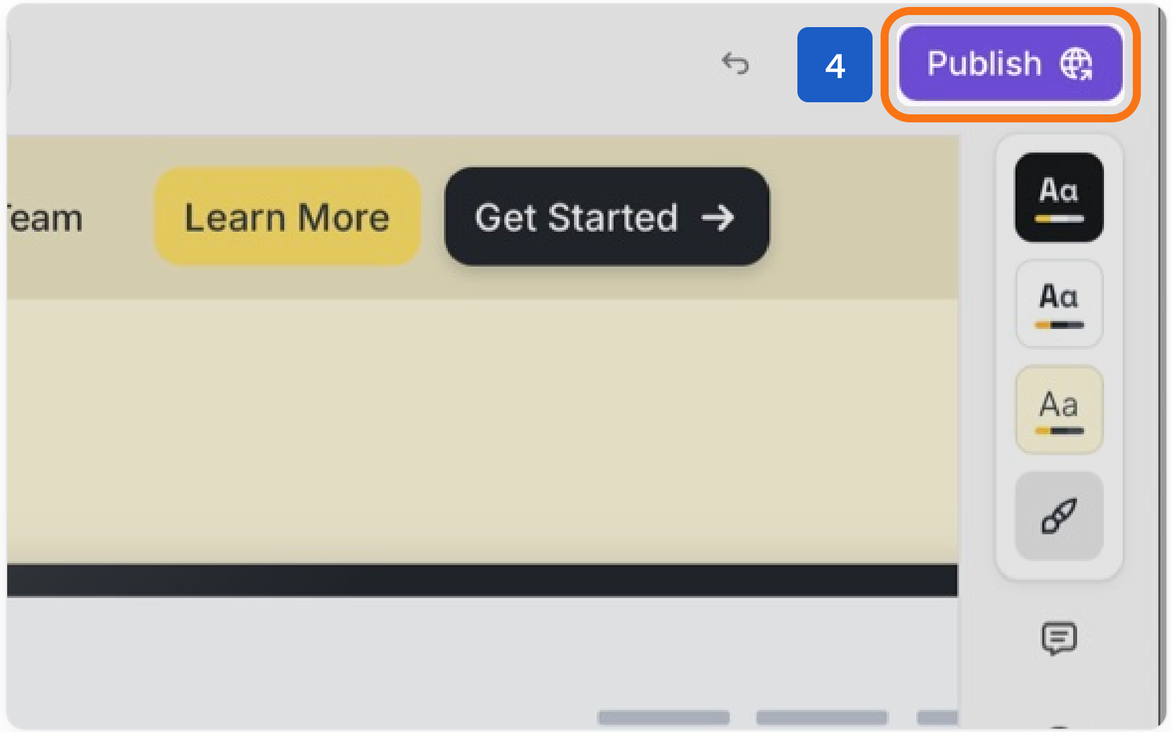

1. Pick a template
2. Describe the problem, let AI draft
3. **Rewrite in their words**
4. Publish on a free subdomain

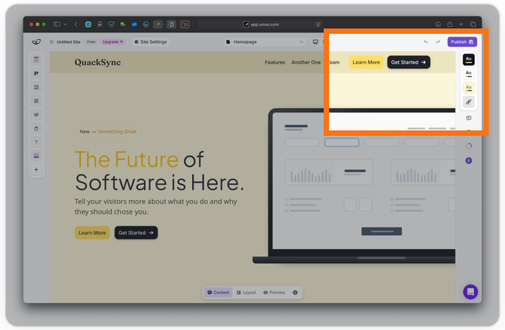
Their sentence goes here.



HOW-TO · BUILD A PAGE · STEP 4 OF 4

# Publish on a free subdomain




1. Pick a template
2. Describe the problem, let AI draft
3. Rewrite in their words
4. **Publish on a free subdomain**

Domains wait until the page earns one

INPUT 3 OF 4 · LAUNCH IT · THE ANSWERS

# Launch it: their words, one button

**1**

Why a page before a product?

**Sell before you own it, as Zappos did. Launch right away**

**2**

What goes on the page?

**Their problem in their words, the outcome they want, one button that proves demand**

**3**

How fast can you build it?

**Today. Any builder works. AI drafts, you rewrite the hero in their words**

INPUT 4 OF 4 · CHAPTER 6 OF 9

# Count it: visitors from your segment

Bring the people who have the problem, and count only them.


01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 ~~Your presentations~~

03 ~~Rank it: what your evidence proves~~

04 ~~Draw it: the line before the data~~

05 ~~Launch it: a page that tests your problem~~

06 **Count it: visitors from your segment**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 Workshop: launch a page that tests your problem

09 Case discussion

INPUT 4 OF 4 · COUNT IT · THREE QUESTIONS

# Who comes, and who counts?

**1**

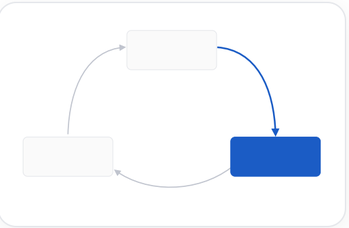
**How many visitors do you need?**

**2**

**Where do you find them?**

**3**

**How do you read the result?**

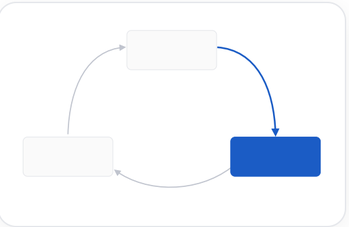


LET'S TALK CONVERSION

# Work backwards from the sign-ups you need

| Impressions | Clicks | Sign-ups |
|---|---|---|
| 740 | 25 | 1 |
| | 3.4% click-through | 4% sign-up |

**Work backwards: how many impressions for the sign-ups you need?**



SPEED MATTERS

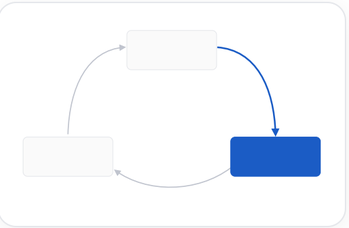
## To get, every day, each of you, at least

# 15 visitors

```
  300 see your link
× 5%  click → 15
  × 7 days → 105
------------------
× 10% sign up → 10
```

**300 a day see your link!**

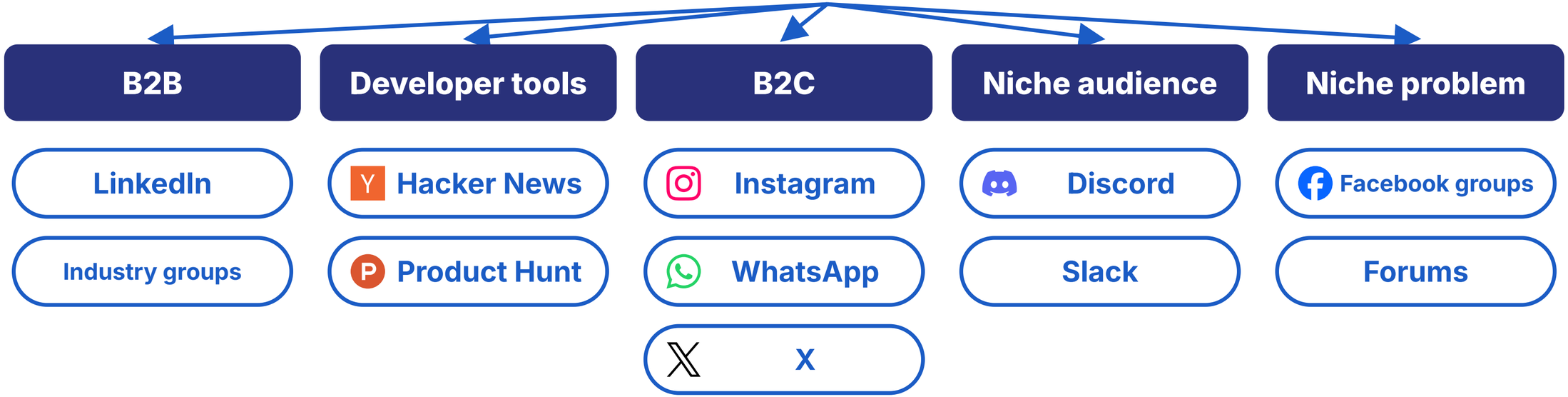
**ILLUSTRATIVE** Arithmetic, redone per student from the homework bar (100 visitors per student) and the default line (10%). The 5% click-through is an assumption, not a benchmark.



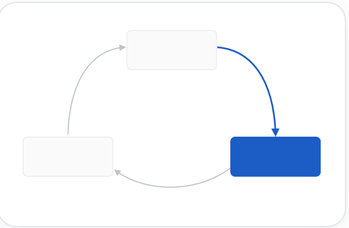
DISTRIBUTION

# Go where your segment already is

**1% inspiration** ~~99% perspiration~~ **99% distribution**



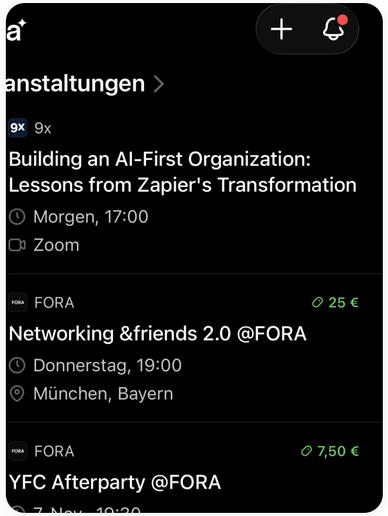

Channels by segment type. Logos are trademarks of their owners.



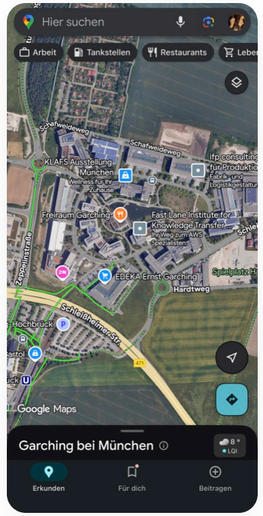
FINDING THE ROOM

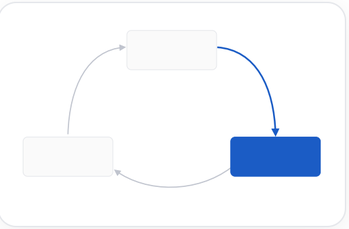
# Name the room, not the channel

## ONLINE COMMUNITIES · ONE NAMED LUMA EVENT




## OFFLINE PLACES · A CAMPUS CANTEEN

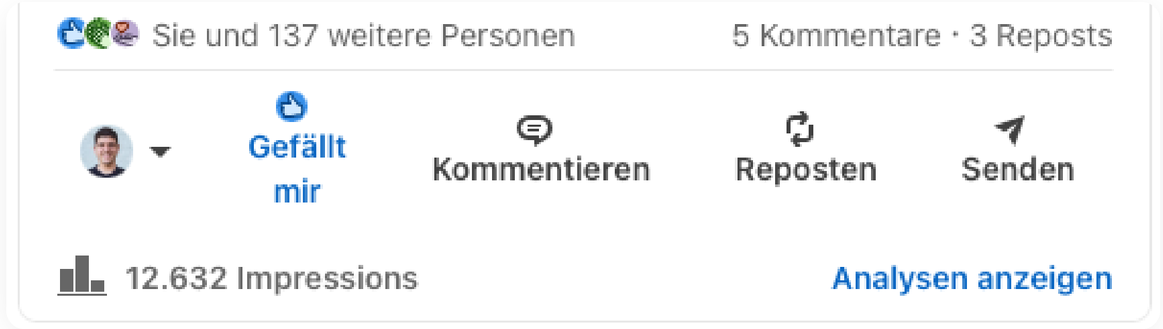


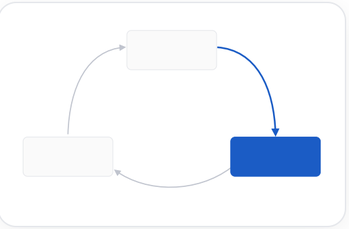


BUILDING AN AUDIENCE

# Post what you learn. Talk to who reacts

1. **Post what you found, what surprised you**
2. **Message everyone who reacts**
3. **Check: are they your segment?**





HOW-TO · LET AI DO THE HEAVY LIFTING

# Let an agent search for you, every Monday

your research agent · scheduled tasks

**Where in-house recruiters talk**

2 Every Monday · 7:00

1 **Task** Find forums, groups and newsletters where in-house recruiters talk about finalists who go quiet. Only new ones, each with a person to contact.

**Monday 7:04** · run 6 · 3 new leads, 11 sources

Forum thread **"Finalist ghosted us after the offer call"**, 63 replies
**Jana K.** Head of Talent, started it
3 ✓ opened

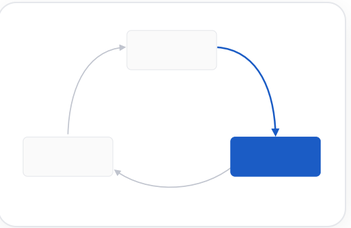
Group for talent acquisition leads, 2,400 members
**Tobias R.** runs the group
Source ↗

Weekly newsletter for in-house recruiters
**Mira L.** editor
Source ↗

1. **Ask where your segment talks**
2. **Schedule it weekly**
3. **Open every source**

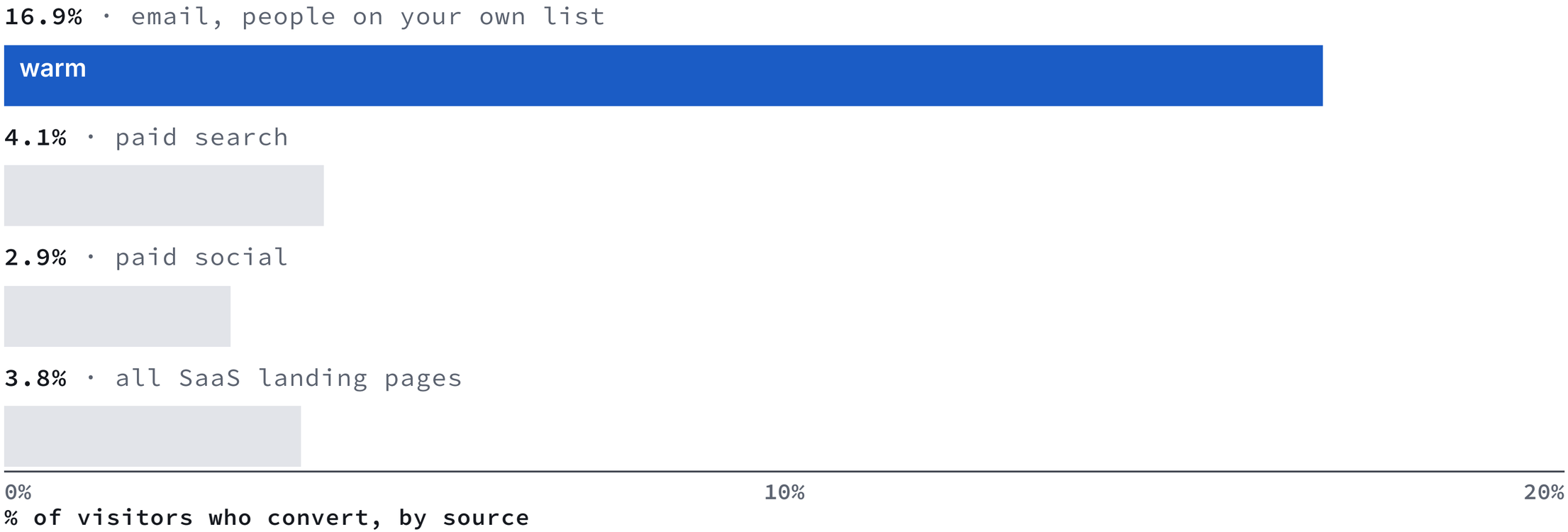
Leads end in a named person.

**ILLUSTRATIVE** Screen prototyped for this course, forum, group, newsletter and people made up.

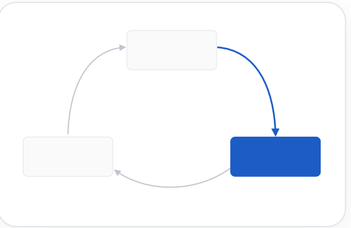


BENCHMARK · WARM AND COLD

# Warm traffic converts. Cold traffic costs




**DATA** Unbounce, Conversion Benchmark Report 2024, SaaS medians. A conversion is any click or form event. Bars to scale, 0 to 20%.



COLD TRAFFIC · BASTIAN'S OWN ACCOUNT

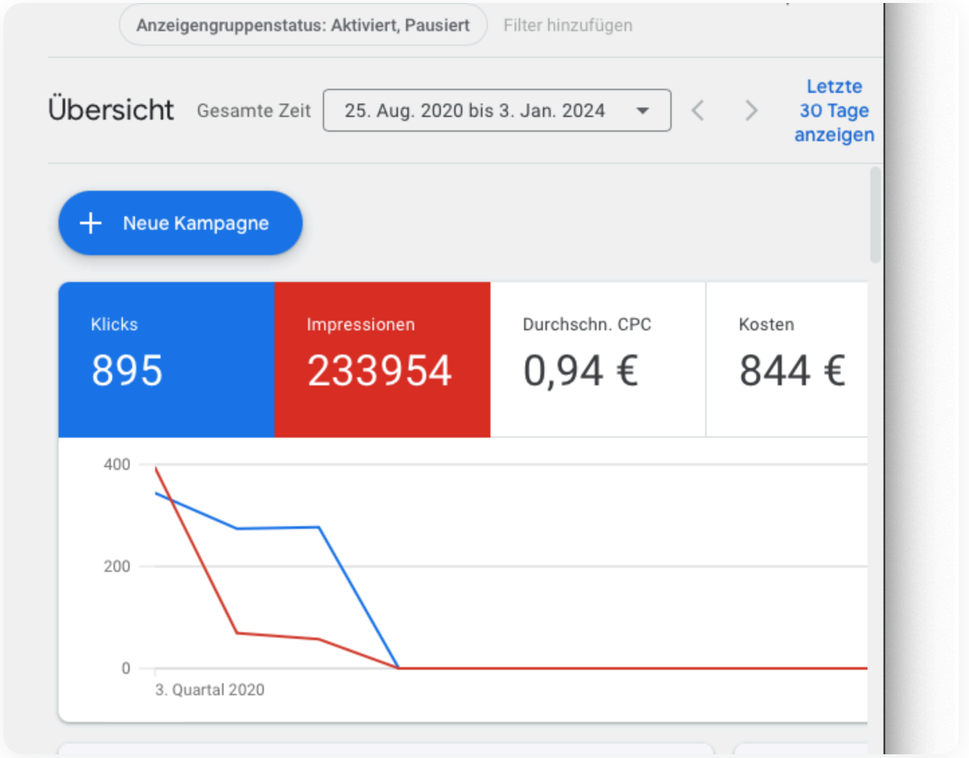
# Cold clicks cost €0.94 each

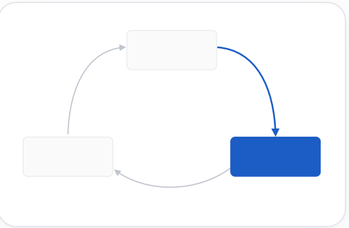
**233,954**
impressions

**895**
clicks

**0.38%**
clicked

**€844**
spent





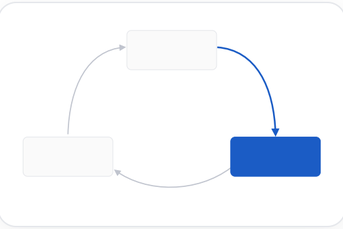
TAGGED LINKS

# Tag every link, or you can't tell who converts

```
yourpage.de/?utm_source=linkedin&utm_medium=post&utm_campaign=m04&utm_content=anna
```

**Where** | **How** | **Which test** | **Who sent it**

**DATA** Google, Analytics Help, URL builders: collect campaign data with custom URLs, as of October 2026. Example link illustrative.



HOW-TO · ANALYTICS · STEP 1 OF 4

# Set up the dashboard before the first visitor

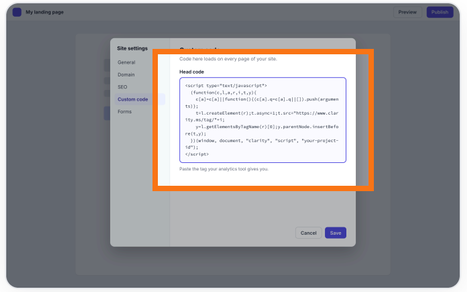
Code here loads on every page of your site.

**Head code**

1

```
<script type="text/javascript">
  (function(c,l,a,r,i,t,y){
    c[a]=c[a]||function(){(c[a].q=c[a].q||[]).push(argumen
ts)};
    t=l.createElement(r);t.async=1;t.src="https://www.clar
ity.ms/tag/"+i;
    y=l.getElementsByTagName(r)[0];y.parentNode.insertBefo
re(t,y);
  })(window, document, "clarity", "script", "your-project-
id");
</script>
```

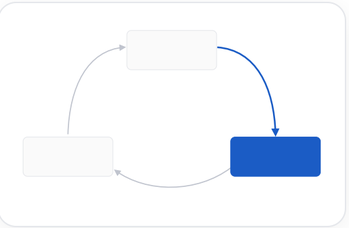
Paste the tag your analytics tool gives you.



1. **Add the tag to your page**
2. Add a consent banner for EU visitors
3. Filter by source
4. Watch your segment's sessions

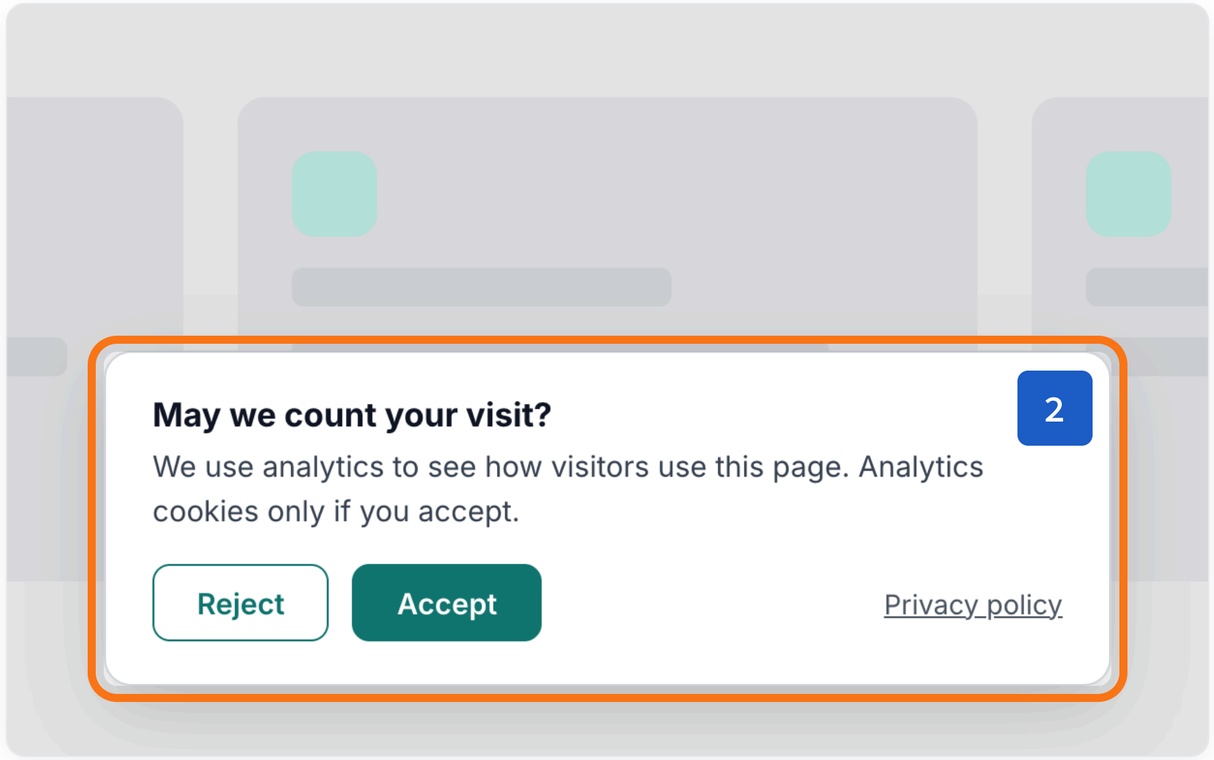
In Clarity, Settings, then Setup, then Install manually

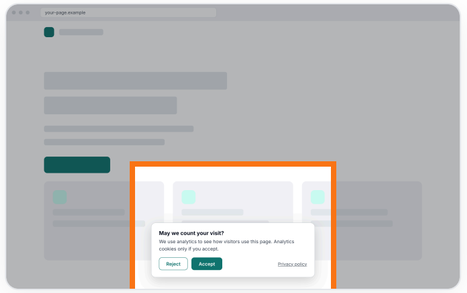
**ILLUSTRATIVE** Screen prototyped for this deck. Setup path from the Microsoft Clarity documentation, as of October 2026.



HOW-TO · ANALYTICS · STEP 2 OF 4

# Add a consent banner for EU visitors

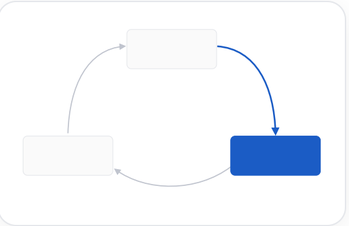


1. Add the tag to your page
2. **Add a consent banner for EU visitors**
3. Filter by source
4. Watch your segment's sessions

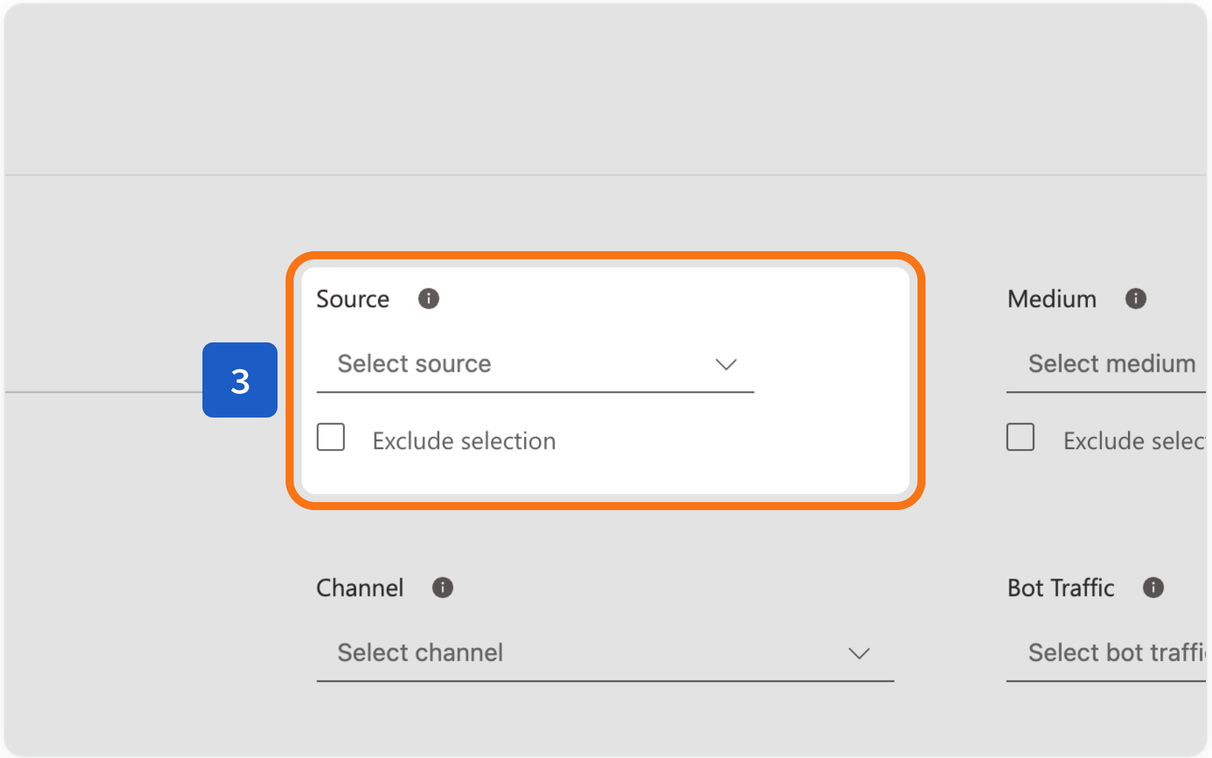
EU visitors: banner first.

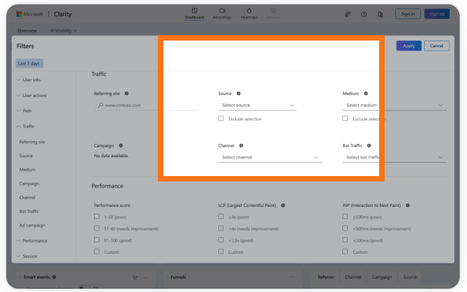
**ILLUSTRATIVE** Screen prototyped for this deck. Consent rules from the Microsoft Clarity documentation, as of October 2026.



HOW-TO · ANALYTICS · STEP 3 OF 4

# Filter by source

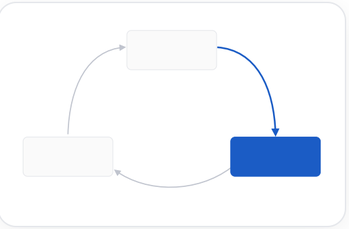


1. Add the tag to your page
2. Add a consent banner for EU visitors
3. **Filter by source**
4. Watch your segment's sessions

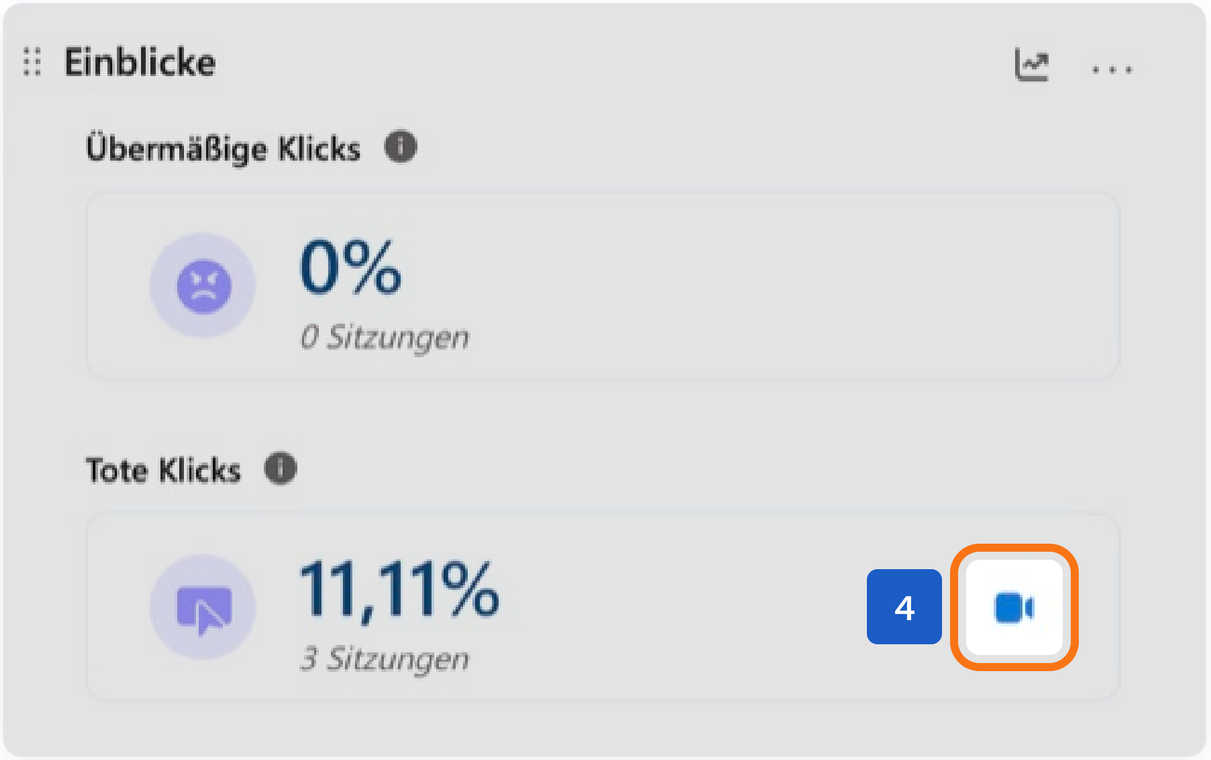
Filters, then Traffic, then Source

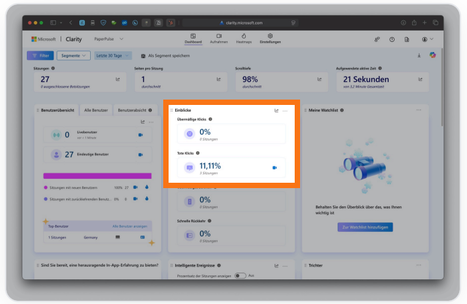
Screenshots of Microsoft Clarity's public live demo as of 26 October 2026, captured with scripts/shots.py.



HOW-TO · ANALYTICS · STEP 4 OF 4

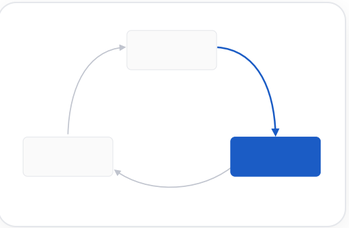
# Watch your segment's sessions



1. Add the tag to your page
2. Add a consent banner for EU visitors
3. Filter by source
4. **Watch your segment's sessions**

Tote Klicks are dead clicks, 11% of sessions

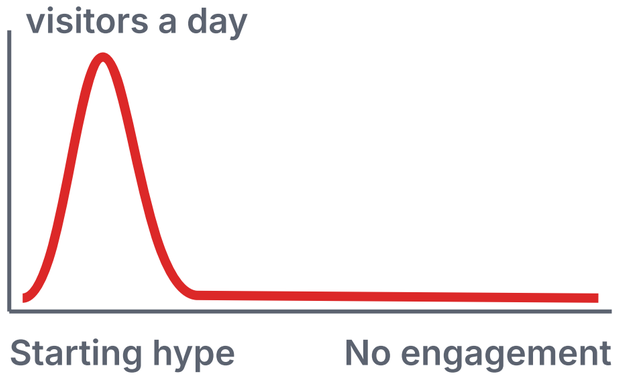


READING YOUR RESULT

# Read the curve, then your number

Each curve shows visitors a day, over the weeks after launch

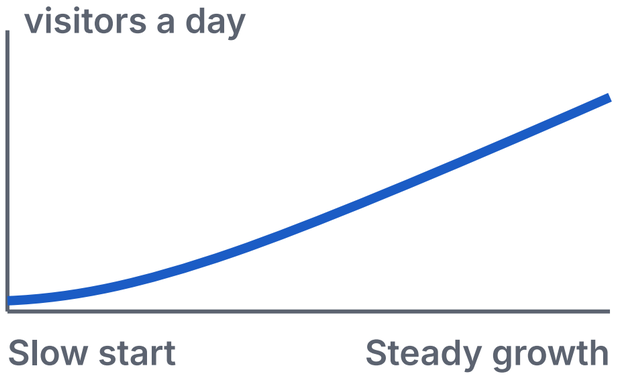
## No interest




Wrong group, problem or words

**Rework the problem space**

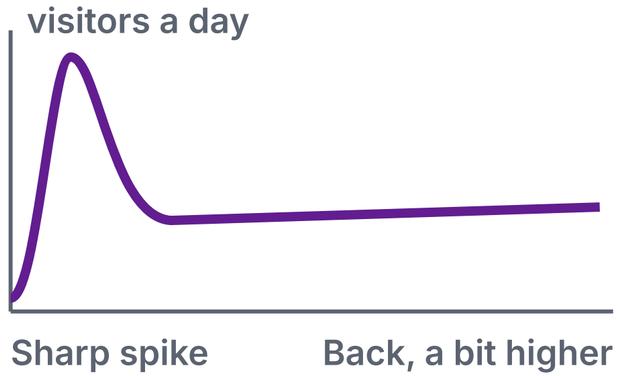
## Organic interest




Right group, sustained interest, good words

**Find more of them**

## External shock



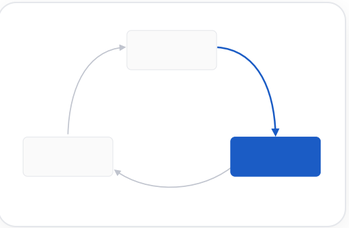

An article or a post went viral

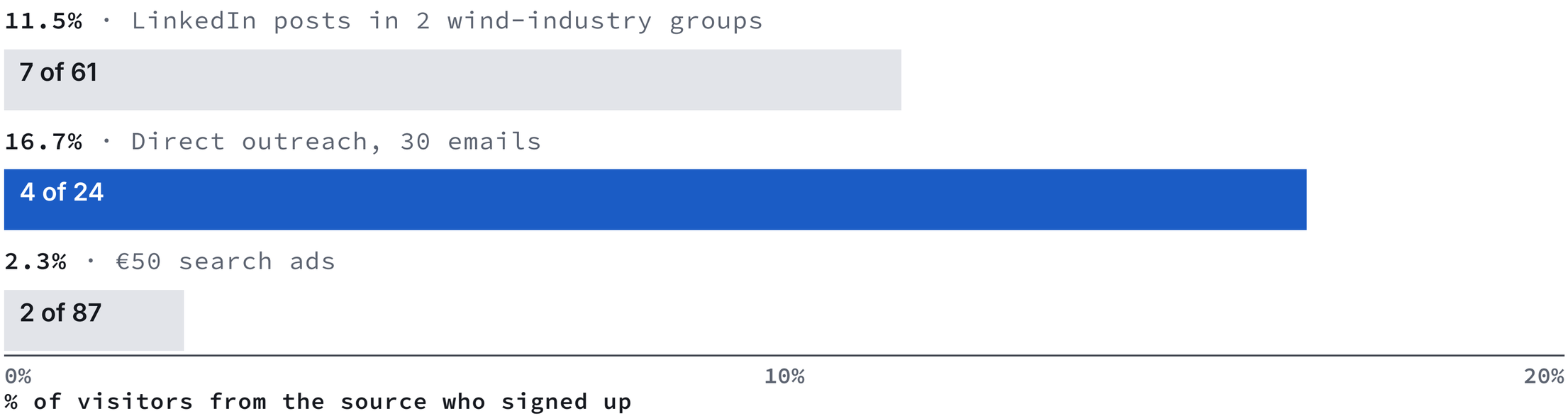
**Don't count the spike**

**Impressions < clicks < sign-ups. Remember the hierarchy of evidence!**

DOUBLE DOWN · AN EXAMPLE

# Double down where your segment converts

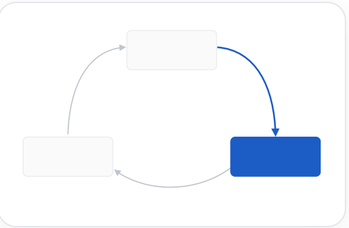





**12.9%**
segment only, 11 of 85

**33**
visitors from friends and uni, excluded

**ILLUSTRATIVE** Synthetic course exemplar, Landing-Page Test, team TurbineTrack. Bars to scale, 0 to 20%. Double down.



NOW YOU · AS A TEAM · 3 MINUTES

# Your traffic math

**Sign-ups** How many do you want?

**Share** What do you expect?

**Visitors** So how many?

**Places** Name three, with people

3:00

OUTPUT

**Three named places**

INPUT 4 OF 4 · COUNT IT · THE ANSWERS

# Count it: your segment, by source

**1**

How many visitors do you need?

**Work backwards from the sign-ups you need: at least 15 a day each**

**2**

Where do you find them?

**Where your segment already is. Name the room, not the channel**

**3**

How do you read the result?

**Tag every link, count only your segment, read the curve, then your number**

CHAPTER 7 OF 9

# Wrap-up and check-out

What you take into the week, and how today went for you.


01 ~~Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship~~

02 ~~Your presentations~~

03 ~~Rank it: what your evidence proves~~

04 ~~Draw it: the line before the data~~

05 ~~Launch it: a page that tests your problem~~

06 ~~Count it: visitors from your segment~~

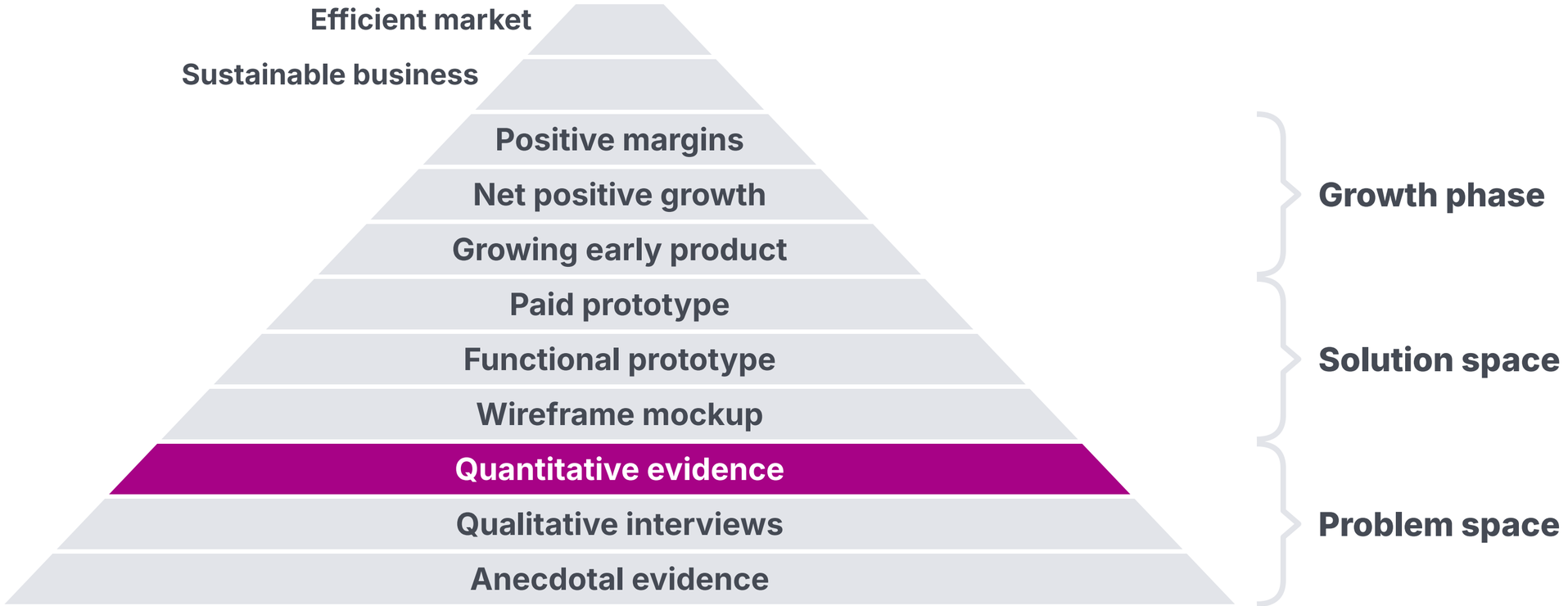
07 **Wrap-up and check-out**

08 Workshop: launch a page that tests your problem

09 Case discussion

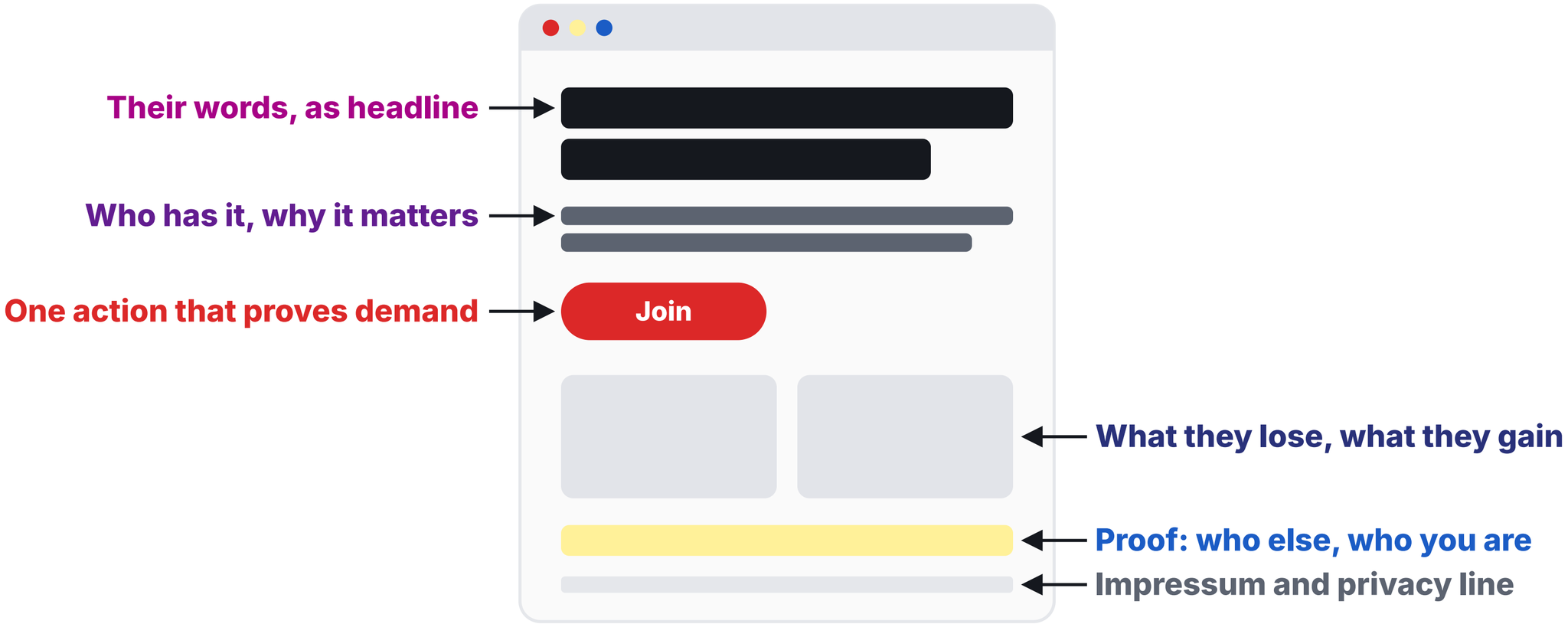
RECAP · STEP THREE IS A SURVEY OR A PAGE, 20+ PEOPLE

# From today you climb from saying to doing



RECAP · YOUR PAGE

# Their problem, their words, one button



REFLECTION 1 OF 3 · THE CONTENT

# What could you apply?



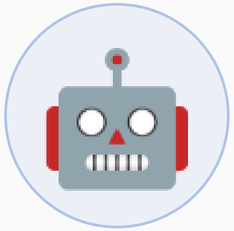
## What could you apply?



## What gave you a hard time?

REFLECTION 2 OF 3 · THE PROCESS

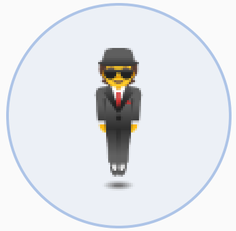
# Man vs. machine



**Where did AI actually help you?**



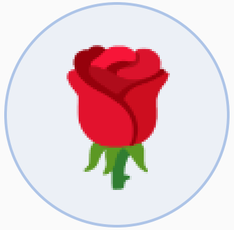
**Where was your genius needed?**



**What are your best hacks to share?**

REFLECTION 3 OF 3 · THE RESULTS

# Rose, thorn, bud



**What was the breakthrough today?**



**What was the hardest part today?**



**What is an idea/feature you didn't have time to finish, but want to explore later?**

HOMEWORK UNTIL NEXT TIME

## Publish one landing page per team, log its pass or fail line before the first visitor arrives, and bring 100 visitors per student from your segment to it.

# 100 each

The learning floor is the live page, the logged line and 30 visitors per student from your segment.

**Your line is logged before anyone visits.**

HOMEWORK · HOW TO DO IT

# Seven moves for the week

1. Start with your Problem space (M03) prospects
2. Go where your segment is
3. Tag every link
4. Never move the line, log any copy change
5. Call three sign-ups each
6. Survey your sign-ups, optionally
7. Get a blind second opinion

HOMEWORK · WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

# A good week ends on your line, not on a feeling

| | GOOD | WEAK |
|---|---|---|
| Line | 10%, logged before launch | Written after the first numbers |
| Traffic | 140 tagged visitors from two recruiter groups | 400 visitors, mostly friends |
| Result | 9 of 140, under the line, segment switched | "Lots of interest!" |

**ILLUSTRATIVE** Made-up example from the Validating problems (M04) homework, the recruiting team of the workshop.

# Sources in this deck

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Bradburn, N. M., Rips, L. J., & Shevell, S. K. (1987). Answering autobiographical questions. *Science*, 236(4798), 157-161.

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NIST/SEMATECH. *e-Handbook of statistical methods*, 7.2.4.1, confidence intervals.

Prather, M. (2000, December 1). Sole proprietor. *Entrepreneur*.

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Unbounce. (2024). *Conversion benchmark report 2024*, SaaS.

# See you next time!

# Workshop: Launch a page that tests your problem

Write the test, launch the page, and send your first visitors before you leave.

What evidence would change your mind?


01 Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship

02 Your presentations

03 **Rank it: what your evidence proves**

04 **Draw it: the line before the data**

05 **Launch it: a page that tests your problem**

06 **Count it: visitors from your segment**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 **Workshop: launch a page that tests your problem**

09 Case discussion

WORKSHOP · STEP 1 OF 3

# Write the test, then the copy

1 STEP 1 · 30 MIN

## WRITE THE TEST, THEN THE COPY

**Decide what result would change your mind**

- → We believe [segment] will [action] when we promise [outcome]
- → Kill line in the Kill Criteria Log, dated, before the page exists
- → Raw notes into an AI, names removed, five hero sections
- → Pick the headline closest to what someone said

**Output** Test card, dated kill line, hero section

**Minutes** 30

30:00

WORKSHOP · STEP 2 OF 3

# Launch in under an hour

2 STEP 2 · 35 MIN

## LAUNCH IN UNDER AN HOUR

**A live page that names their problem, asks for one action**

→ Their words, why it matters, what changes, one button
→ Form: email plus one segment question
→ Impressum and privacy line, or it stays offline
→ Analytics with visitors and sign-ups per source, then publish
→ Five-second test with another team

**Output** A public link and analytics that count

**Minutes** 35

35:00

WORKSHOP · STEP 3 OF 3

# Bring your segment, then commit

3 STEP 3 · 25 MIN

## BRING YOUR SEGMENT, THEN COMMIT

**Leave with visitors on their way**

→ Work backwards: 10 sign-ups at 10% need 100 visitors
→ Prospects first, then communities, groups, newsletters
→ One tagged link per student and channel
→ First messages sent before you leave
→ Each student picks floor or full bar, midweek pace

**Output** Tagged links, sent messages, targets, pace

**Minutes** 25

25:00

ARRIVED EMPTY-HANDED?

# Start in the forums where they complain

No interview notes? Copy your segment's exact sentences from the forums where it complains, mark the promise as assumed, and post your link there in Step 3.

HOMEWORK UNTIL NEXT TIME

## Publish one landing page per team, log its pass or fail line before the first visitor arrives, and bring 100 visitors per student from your segment to it.

# 100 each

The learning floor is the live page, the logged line and 30 visitors per student from your segment.

**Your line is logged before anyone visits.**

# See you next time!

MODULE 04 · VALIDATING PROBLEMS · CASE DISCUSSION · ABOUT 90 MINUTES

# Case discussion: Fairphone

Stand in Fairphone's shoes on 13 May 2013 and decide whether to sell 5,000 phones before making one.

Do you open the pre-sale on this benchmark?


01 Previously on Ambitious Entrepreneurship

02 Your presentations

03 **Rank it: what your evidence proves**

04 **Draw it: the line before the data**

05 **Launch it: a page that tests your problem**

06 **Count it: visitors from your segment**

07 Wrap-up and check-out

08 Workshop: launch a page that tests your problem

09 **Case discussion**

CASE · FAIRPHONE, AMSTERDAM, 2010 TO 13 MAY 2013

# Three years of campaign, one month to sell 5,000




**DATA** Validating problems (M04) case, timeline and Exhibit 1. Nothing after 13 May 2013.

CASE · MONDAY 13 MAY 2013 · VOTE 1 OF 2

# Open the pre-sale on this benchmark, or not yet?

OPTION A

## Open the pre-sale on this benchmark

OPTION B

## Not yet

**€325**
the price, paid up front

**5,000**
phones sold

**15 June**
2013, the deadline

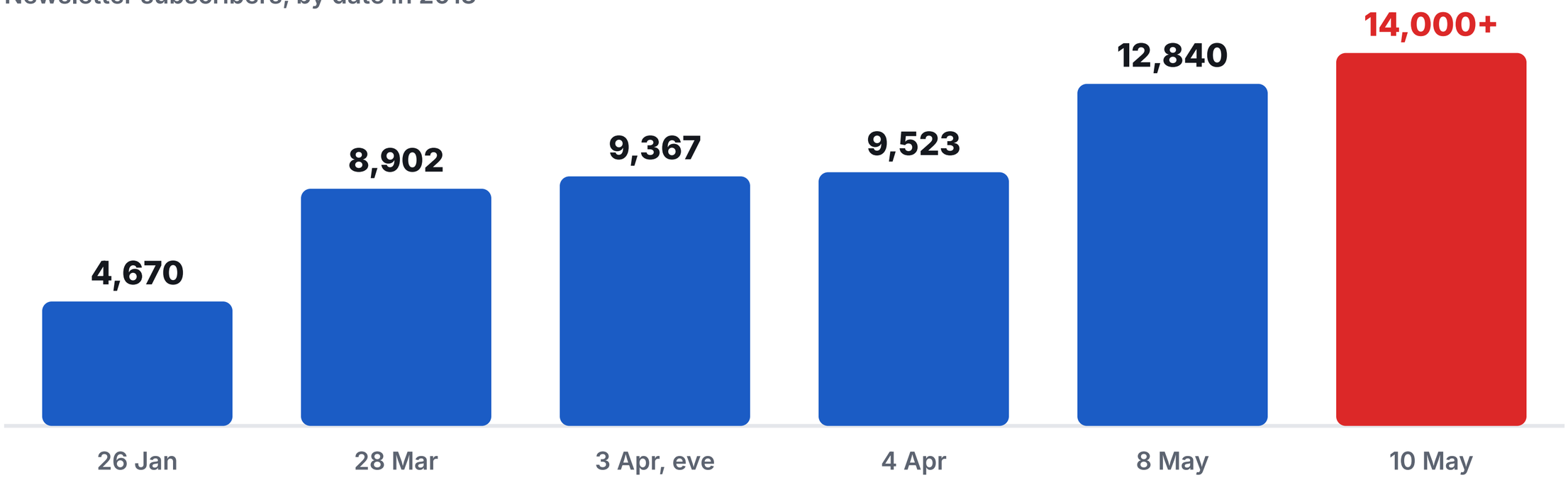
**Refund**
if the orders are cancelled

**DATA** Validating problems (M04) case, Exhibit 2 (shop terms, articles 4.3 and 4.4, adopted 13 May 2013) and Exhibit 3.

CASE · EXHIBIT 1 · NEWSLETTER SUBSCRIBERS, 2013

# What do 14,000 sign-ups prove?

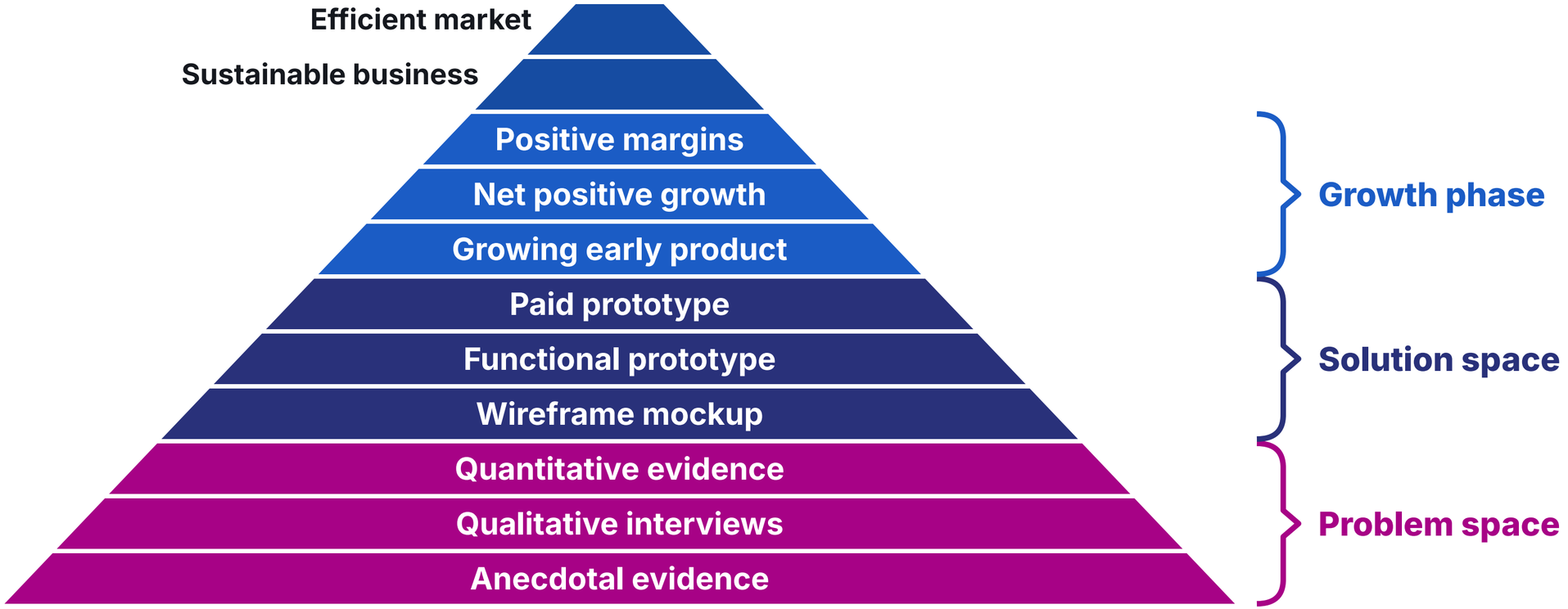
Newsletter subscribers, by date in 2013




**DATA** Validating problems (M04) case, Exhibit 1: archived newsletter counter, Fairphone blog of 4 April 2013 (company figures for the evening of 3 April and for 4 April), Telecompaper of 10 May 2013 ("more than 14,000", drawn at 14,000). Bars to scale, 0 to 15,000.

CASE · DIAGNOSIS

# Which step does each piece stand on?



# Fairphone has a sales benchmark of 5,000 (five thousand) mobile phones, which must be sold before the 15th of June 2013.

**Shop terms, article 4.3**, adopted 13 May 2013. If Fairphone cancels on a miss, the buyer gets "a full refund of the money the Customer already has paid" (4.4)

**DATA** Validating problems (M04) case, Exhibit 2: Fairphone B.V., Customer Terms and Conditions, articles 4.3 and 4.4, adopted 13 May 2013.

CASE · BOARD PLAN

# Is 5,000 by 15 June a good test of demand?

| | Vote 1 | Vote 2 | Prediction |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Evidence on 13 May**<br>and its step | What, and which step? | | |
| **What it proves**<br>and what it doesn't | Proves · doesn't prove | | |
| **The line**<br>as a test | Count · threshold · date<br>Pass · miss | | |
| **5,000 buyers**<br>from where? | Share of the list, then? | | |

CASE · VOTE 2 OF 2

# Same question. Who moved, and why?

OPTION A

**Open the pre-sale on this benchmark**

OPTION B

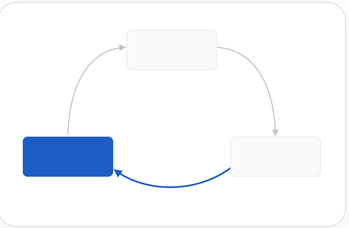
**Not yet**

**€325**
the price, paid up front

**5,000**
phones sold

**15 June**
2013, the deadline

**Refund**
if the orders are cancelled



CASE · BRIDGE

# Before your page exists, write your line

Fairphone wrote its line into its terms before the first buyer arrived.

| | |
|---|---|
| **We are right if** | [X]% or more by [date], logged today |
| **Then** | pass: [next step] · fail: switch segment or problem |

**FRAMEWORK** The last two rows of the test card, after Bland and Osterwalder (2019), as on slide 30.

# See you next time!